Selected stand-alone Bible lessons

Selected original and adapted Bible lessons, with teacher and student resources and source acknowledgments retained. The JBI demonstration applies the established Seven Laws of the Teacher method.

Full teaching files

abide in christ millheim- student	*1 pages*
abide in christ millheim- teacher	*2 pages*
ENCOUNTERING GOD STUDENT NEW	*1 pages*
encountering GOD TEACHER NEW	*3 pages*
Genesis 6 5 KIDS WS	*3 pages*
JBI Lesson for kids abridged 5-7 minutes; psalm 12 6-7	*3 pages*
JBI Lesson for kids Psalm 12 6-7	*3 pages*
KIDS CLASS EASTER 2ND GRADE 2021	*1 pages*
MISSIONS CONFERENCE KIDS CURRICULUM SAINT PATRICK	*13 pages*
STUDENT COPY ISSUES OF LIFE STUDY	*2 pages*
TEACHER COPY ISSUES OF LIFE STUDY	*2 pages*
student CLOSE TO CHRIST	*1 pages*
teacher CLOSE TO CHRIST	*4 pages*
student COPY FUNDAMENTALS OF THE FAITH (1)	*1 pages*
TEACHER COPY FUNDAMENTALS OF THE FAITH (1)	*2 pages*
God moves satan counters	*5 pages*
God moves satan counters student new	*2 pages*
JBI LAWS OF THE TEACHER LESSON (1)	*1 pages*
key of david student	*2 pages*
key of david teacher	*6 pages*
laodicea	*5 pages*
laodicea student	*1 pages*

Selected stand-alone Bible lessons continued

STUDENT prayer study	*1 pages*
TEACHER prayer study	*1 pages*
Proverbs 11 High School Devotional Lesson	*4 pages*
TEARS OF CHRIST student	*1 pages*
TEARS OF CHRIST teacher	*3 pages*

Teacher and student editions are components of this one portfolio entry.

1. The Real Vine — vs. 1
    a. Vs. 1- Jesus is painting a picture of a vine and branches on the vine. There is much to learn from this relationship and our relationship to Christ (he made the vine and branches!)
    b. Jesus calls himself the "true vine" not just the vine (Prov. 16:25: John 14:6)
2. The Refining of the Branches — vss. 2–3
    a. There is a refining of fire (trouble, hurt, pain; **not Hell**) for branches who do not bear fruit (2a, 6) AND, there is a refining by the word of God for those who bear fruit (2b)
    b. If we allow God to purge our lives through his word, trials, persecution, etc.. we will bear more fruit (Eph. 5:26; Psa. 119:9-11; 1 Peter 1:6–7; James 1:2-4)
    c. We also see that, if we do not allow God to purge us, so that we can bring forth fruit, we will still endure hardship (Hebrews 12:6; Galatians 6:7–8; Proverbs 13:15; Jeremiah 2:19)
3. The Reliance of the Branches — vss. 4–5
    a. We are totally and completely reliant on Jesus Christ in our Christian lives
    b. There was nothing we could do to earn our salvation, and there is nothing we can do in our own power to bear fruit as his disicples
    c. True fruitfulness in our lives comes from our "abiding" in him. Our connection to him through prayer and the Word of God (**vs. 7, if his "words abide in us"**) (Psalm 127:1; 2 Corinthians 3:5; Psa. 1:1-3; 2 Cor. 12:9-10; 1 Cor. 1:25-29)
4. The Results of Abiding—or Not Abiding — vss. 6–8
    a. When We Abide
        i. God is glorified- This is our ultimate goal in life and the result of bearing fruit for God (vs. 8; Phili. 1:11; 1 Cor. 10:31; Isa. 43:7)
        ii. We Become Disciples- This is the result of bearing fruit, not a prerequisite to it. If you are not bearing fruit, you are not a disciple (vs. 8)
    b. When We Do Not Abide
        i. Our lives will "burn up" in the end as dead wood (vs. 6; 1 Cor. 3:11-15)
        ii. We show that we are not truly disciples (John 8:31)
        iii. God cannot be glorified in our lives- vs. 8

1. The Real Vine — vs. 1
    a. Vs. 1- Jesus is painting a picture of a vine and branches on the vine. There is much to learn from this relationship and our relationship to Christ (he made the vine and branches!)
        i. Romans 1:20- For the invisible things of him from the creation of the world are clearly seen, being understood by the things that are made, even his eternal power and Godhead; so that they are without excuse:
        ii. The Vine (Jesus)- Provides sap, water, nutrients, and gives life to the branches. The Vine is essential for the growth of the branches. Without the vine, the branches do not exist, and they have no life.
        iii. The Branches (Us/believers)- They exist to produce fruit and carry the fruit of the vine. They cannot of themselves produce fruit, YET if they are not allowing the nutrients of the vine to flow through them, if they are refusing to grow, they cannot bear/hold fruit.
            1. It is not about the ability of the branch to produce fruit, but its ability to allow the vine to grow it and allow the vine to use it to bear fruit
    b. Jesus calls himself the "true vine" not just the vine (Prov. 16:25: John 14:6)
        i. Right from the beginning he is reminding us that there are many "vines" out there. Things that we try to go to for our sustanance. What Jesus alone can provide us, we are looking for elsewhere.
        ii. This is an age old issue. Israel did this in the OT. When they served other gods, they did it because of what those gods promised to provide for them.
            1. Baal, the Canaanite god of storms, rain, and agriculture.
            2. Ashtoreth- The Promise of Fertility
                a. We do the same thing when we covet after and live for other things above God. We have to be careful. There is only one true vine.
2. The Refining of the Branches — vss. 2–3
    a. There is a refining of fire (trouble, hurt, pain; **not Hell**) for branches who do not bear fruit (2a, 6) AND, there is a refining by the word of God for those who bear fruit (2b)
    b. If we allow God to purge our lives through his word, trials, persecution, etc.. we will bear more fruit (Eph. 5:26; Psa. 119:9-11; 1 Peter 1:6–7; James 1:2-4)
        i. It is a process of pain. It is not comfortable. It includes submitting to what God says over what you want. It includes going through persecution. These are how God purges us
    c. We also see that, if we do not allow God to purge us, so that we can bring forth fruit, we will still endure hardship (Hebrews 12:6; Galatians 6:7–8; Proverbs 13:15; Jeremiah 2:19)
        i. Following God is hard. 2 Tim. 3:12 tell us that, "Yea, and all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution." It is part of the Christian life, but God uses it for our good! To purge out sin and things that weigh us down and keep us from bearing fruit! AND NOT FOLLOWING GOD IS HARD. He equates the life of a believer who is not bearing fruit (disciples) to being taken away and cast into fire. Your life will be full of trouble BUT WITH NO DESIRED END. NO FRUIT. NO REWARD.
        ii. Choose the hardship you want. Be pruned now or be burned later.
3. The Reliance of the Branches — vss. 4–5
    a. We are totally and completely reliant on Jesus Christ in our Christian lives

b. There was nothing we could do to earn our salvation, and there is nothing we can do in our own power to bear fruit as his disicples

c. True fruitfulness in our lives comes from our "abiding" in him. Our connection to him through prayer and the Word of God (**vs. 7, if his "words abide in us"**) (Psalm 127:1; 2 Corinthians 3:5; Psa. 1:1-3; 2 Cor. 12:9-10; 1 Cor. 1:25-29)

i. We must understand that fruit will only come in our lives through abiding and trusting in God's power through us. The branch has no ability in itself, it simply allows the vine to work through it and bear fruit on it.

ii. What are we relying on to be fruitful? Our talents, our wisdom, our methods, etc.. IF SO, WE WILL NOT BE FRUITFUL.

iii. He commands us to abide. It is not a request. And He definitevely says that if we don't we can do NOTHING OUTSIDE of a growing, thriving, abiding relationship with him on a daily basis.

1. That is what **abiding** means. Not occasionally reading our Bible, praying only when we need something, or seeking Christ only during difficult times, but continually remaining close to Him through daily prayer, dependence, obedience, and the Word of God. Abiding is a consistent way of life.

2. CAN WE TRULY SAY WE ARE ABIDING IN HIM? If we see no fruit in our lives/ministries, then maybe we are not connected to the VINE in the way we ought to be. AND…

3. We must understand, there is no way to abide in Christ but through his word and prayer. This is our abiding. This is how the Spirit of God teaches us, moves us, empowers us, etc.. How well are we abiding?

4. The Results of Abiding—or Not Abiding — vss. 6–8

a. When We Abide

i. God is glorified- This is our ultimate goal in life and the result of bearing fruit for God (vs. 8; Phili. 1:11; 1 Cor. 10:31; Isa. 43:7)

ii. We Become Disciples- This is the result of bearing fruit, not a prerequisite to it. If you are not bearing fruit, you are not a disciple (vs. 8)

b. When We Do Not Abide

i. Our lives will "burn up" in the end as dead wood (vs. 6; 1 Cor. 3:11-15)

ii. We show that we are not truly disciples (John 8:31)

iii. God cannot be glorified in our lives- vs. 8



AN ENCOUNTER WITH GOD

1) With summer camp coming up next week, today we will examine a biblical response to encountering God. We will look at Paul on the road to Damascus and how God intersected his life at a time that Paul was not expecting. We will then see how Paul responded and how we ought to respond as we prepare for our lives to be _____ by God in the same way at camp next week.

2) **Acts 9:1-23**

   a) GETTING CAUGHT IN A _____ SITUATION (vs 1-4a)

      i) Paul is carrying letters that give him permission to seize and kill anyone who professes Christ

      ii) Are we carrying anything that would embarrass/frighten us if we encountered God at camp?

   b) GETTING CALLED OUT AND _____ DOWN (vs. 4b-5)

      i) Paul gets called out by name

      ii) Paul is told the severity of what he has done 2x

      iii) God says that Paul has been kicking against the pricks

         (1) What are you kicking against in your life? (Psalm 10:11-15; Prov. 1:24-30; 29:1)

   c) A BIBLICAL RESPONSE (vs. 6a)

      i) Fearfully and humbly respond "Lord, that wilt thou have me to do?" (Acts 2:37; 16:28-30; Isa. 6:8)

         (1) Notice the godly fear and humility that is accompanied with an encounter with God. You MUST respond this way to God when he shows up. If not, there are consequences. (Luke 20:17-18)

   d) WAITING AND _____ (vs. 6b-12)

      i) In verses 11-12 we see exactly what Paul did. He took a step of faith and went to Damascus like he was told and he PRAYED waiting for God to show him what to do. (he likely didn't know how to/wasn't sure of how to pray, everything he believed before he now is shown was not true) (Lam. 3:25; Psalm 27:14; Col. 4:2)

   e) UNUSUAL PEOPLE/CIRCUMSTANCES (vs. 10-19)

      i) God uses Ananias to lead Paul to salvation and tell him what he is supposed to do. This is the only account we have on this disciple in the Bible.

   f) POWERFUL TRANSFORMATION MET WITH PERSECUTION (vs. 20-23)

      i) Just a few days after he was traveling to Damascus and seize and kill Christians, he was now preaching Christ to people in such a way that amazed and confounded the hearers!

      ii) Just as quickly as Paul changed, so came with it sever persecution (2 Tim. 3:12)

3) As we have seen today, having an encounter with God is very serious business. We cannot take it lightly. As we approach summer camp, I am confident that all of us will encounter God in some way as we here from the word of God daily and are secluded from our usual distractions. No doubt we need to be preparing so that we are not caught off guard and so we can respond to God and what he wants us to do. Our preparedness and response can be what changes our lives _____, from this camp moving forward.



AN ENCOUNTER WITH GOD

1) With summer camp coming up next week, today we will examine a biblical response to encountering God. We will look at Paul on the road to Damascus and how God intersected his life at a time that Paul was not expecting. We will then see how Paul responded and how we ought to respond as we prepare for our lives to be **intersected** by God in the same way at camp next week.

2) **Acts 9:1-23**

   a) GETTING CAUGHT IN A BAD SITUATION (vs 1-4a)

      i) Paul is carrying letters that give him permission to seize and kill anyone who professes Christ

         (1) Imagine God showing up in front of you, and you have all of these papers you are carrying that say that you are allowed to kill anyone who professes Jesus Christ

         (2) This light was so bright that it caused Paul to fall to the ground and be temporarily blinded

         (3) No doubt these papers would have fallen to the ground also and would have been all over the place

         (4) Imagine the fear in Paul's heart. Just a few moments prior, he was so confident that Jesus was a heretic and dead that he was confident to kill anyone who followed him, and now to realize in a moment that you were wrong this whole time and the guy you were persecuting against is alive and he is God!

      ii) Are we carrying anything that would embarrass/frighten us if we encountered God at camp?

         (1) Are you involved in sin?

         (2) Are you not obeying something God is telling you to do?

         (3) Are you involved in friendships you ought not to be?

         (4) What baggage are you carrying that will embarrass and even scare you when God shows up at camp?

            (a) God will speak to you at camp. You don't want to be in a situation where you are going to encounter God and be completely caught off guard because you weren't ready and because you didn't truly believe that God was going to speak to you and require of you what he has been calling you to do (get out of sin, read/pray more consistently, break up with significant other, quit sport/show/theater/etc.. that has been taking all of your time, etc..)

   b) GETTING CALLED OUT AND KNOCKED DOWN (vs. 4b-5)

      i) Paul gets called out by name

         (1) Don't make the mistake of thinking that God will not be speaking to you individually with what you have been dealing with

         (2) Don't focus on what God is saying to your friends, guests, bf/ gf, etc.. Focus on what God is saying to you! Unless you are perfect going into camp, God has something to say to you specifically

      ii) Paul is told the severity of what he has done 2x

         (1) What Paul may have thought was innocent (he didn't think he was persecuting Jesus personally and he did not believe in Jesus as Lord) was NOT and when he was called out by Jesus here, Jesus calls him out (he says the Paul persecuted HIM twice)

(2) Don't make the mistake of thinking that what you are doing is no big deal. God will call you out personally and he will call you out based on his standards, not yours!

(3) If God has to stop you in the middle of your journey, you think you are just going to camp for fun and games and friends, but God will BREAK YOU and BLIND YOU and KNOCK YOU DOWN at camp AND HE WILL CALL YOU OUT on your sin and disobedience to him. This is not a good feeling and you don't have to endure this if you simply correct course now.

iii) God says that Paul has been kicking against the pricks

(a) He is saying that Paul was purposely and knowingly kicking against belief in him (Jesus) even at his own expense (pain)

(b) This is what we do. We come to church week after week and discipleship meeting after meeting and we hear from God and we are told to make changes and then we continue on and don't change anything. This causes us internal pain as we know what we are supposed to do and we know we aren't doing it. If we won't obey, Jesus will call us out on it and it will not be pleasant!

(2) What are you kicking against in your life? (Psalm 10:11-15; Prov. 1:24-30; 29:1)

(a) What has God been calling you to do that you have been putting off?

(b) What do you know you are supposed to do that you have been refusing to simply obey and do?

c) A BIBLICAL RESPONSE (vs. 6a)

i) Fearfully and humbly respond "Lord, that wilt thou have me to do?" (Acts 2:37; 16:28-30; Isa. 6:8)

(1) Notice the godly fear and humility that is accompanied with an encounter with God. You MUST respond this way to God when he shows up. If not, there are consequences. (Luke 20:17-18)

d) WAITING AND PRAYING (vs. 6b-12)

i) In verses 11-12 we see exactly what Paul did. He took a step of faith and went to Damascus like he was told and he PRAYED waiting for God to show him what to do. (he likely didn't know how to/wasn't sure of how to pray, everything he believed before he now is shown was not true) (Lam. 3:25; Psalm 27:14; Col. 4:2)

ii) God is standing right in front of Paul in person, you would think this would be a perfect time for God to tell him what he is supposed to do, but God says to go to Damascus (continue the way you were going) and then it will be told you what to do

e) UNUSUAL PEOPLE/CIRCUMSTANCES (vs. 10-19)

i) God uses Ananias to lead Paul to salvation and tell him what he is supposed to do. This is the only account we have on this disciple in the Bible.

(1) Other than being in the right place at the right time, it seems like he is not an overly significant disciple at this time. God uses him because he was in the right path of where Paul was going.

(2) Be ready for God to use unusual or just different people than you are used to, to reach you and speak to you at camp

f) POWERFUL TRANSFORMATION MET WITH PERSECUTION (vs. 20-23)

i) Just a few days after he was traveling to Damascus and seize and kill Christians, he was now preaching Christ to people in such a way that amazed and confounded the hearers!

(1) Do not undersell what God can do with you in just a few days! You can go into camp as far away from God as possible and leave camp on fire for the Lord and amazing those back home!

(2) Do not undersell what an encounter with GOD can do to you! He did it to me at camp in 2016!

ii) Just as quickly as Paul changed, so came with it sever persecution (2 Tim. 3:12)

(1) Do not be fooled into thinking that you won't be met with all sorts of persecution when you get home and God has changed you completely!

(2) Do not be surprised by where it comes from. It comes from those closest to you! (vs. 23- The Jews, among whom he was chiefest just a few days prior, now are seeking to kill him. Those CLOSEST to you will be those who bring the most persecution to the new you. It is not because they are evil, but because the enemy that is using them is evil!

3) As we have seen today, having an encounter with God is very serious business. We cannot take it lightly. As we approach summer camp, I am confident that all of us will encounter God in some way as we here from the word of God daily and are secluded from our usual distractions. No doubt we need to be preparing so that we are not caught off guard and so we can respond to God and what he wants us to do. Our preparedness and response can be what changes our lives **forever**, from this camp moving forward.

Hebrews 11:1,6

Practice 1

Now faith is the _____ of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen. But without _____ it is impossible to please him: for he that _____ to God must _____that he is, and that he is a _____ of them that _____ seek him.

Word Bank:

substance

faith

Believe

cometh

Diligently

Rewarder

Practice 2

Practice 2

Now _____ is the _____ of things hoped for, the _____ of things not seen. But without _____ it is _____ to please him: for he that _____ to God must _____that he is, and that he is a _____ of them that _____

Word Bank:

substance

Faith

faith

Cometh

evidence

believe

rewarder

Diligently

impossible

THEME: God's word is perfect and we can FULLY trust it. Therefore, we should obey it!

I. Today we will be looking at two verses out of Psalm chapter 12. These verses are absolutely important to us in our everyday lives, and understanding them is key to walking closely with God everyday. By understanding these verses we can; fully trust in the Bible as our guide for our lives, find comfort in time of need, and find answers to many questions we have in life and that we will have throughout our lives.

   A. Our verses are in Psalm chapter 12, verses 6 and 7

II. ***"The words of the Lord are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O Lord, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."***

   A. First it is important to mention that when this says "the words of the Lord" it is talking about the Bible. The Bible is God's Word to us, it is how he talks with us.

   B. What does the word pure mean?

      1. Pure- "unmixed, incorrupt, without spot, not dirtied; perfect; or to be clear"
      2. **HOOK-** Now to demonstrate what the word pure means I brought 2 cups of water and this cup of dirt from my yard
         a) Water cup 1 is the word of God
         b) Water cup 2 is the word of God
         c) The dirt represents the ways that the devil tries to attack the word of God and dirty it up. Subtracting to it, adding to it, and changing what it says wherever he can.
         d) Add dirt to the second cup
         e) Now is this a cup of water? NO! It has water, but it also contains dirt. What we would call this now is MUD!! Not water. This (glass 1) is clean, fresh, and PURE water!

f) In this same way, when the word of God is changed, added to, or subtracted from, it may contain the words of God some places, but it is not the word of God. And you definitely wouldn't want to drink it!

C. "As silver tried in a furnace of earth"

1. Here, God compares his word to silver. God is comparing his Word to something that is beautiful and of very high value!

D. "Thou shalt keep them, O LORD, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."

1. God not only says his Word is pure, but he promises to keep and preserve it forever!
2. **PRESERVE**- To keep from destruction, or from corruption. To keep PURE, from decay.
3. Think of something you had that was very special to you. Maybe a really nice toy or game or present that you got. Think of how well you took care of it. Did you let it out of your sight? Did you know where it was at all times? Would you let it be broken or lost if you could help it at all? Absolutely NOT!
    a) God has taken care to keep and to preserve his pure word from being corrupted. This means that the pure word of God exists out there somewhere! This is the Bible we have today, the King James Bible.
    b) THIS IS THE KEY: We can know that the Bible we hold is the word of God, and that God is speaking to us directly from it. We can trust every single word in it! Knowing this, we should obey what it tells us to do, and we should treat it as a great gift, something of high value, like silver!

E. What do we do now?

1. We know that our Bible is the perfect and pure word of God. We know all the trouble God went through in order to keep and preserve it for us, and how important it is to him that we have it. So

we MUST BELIEVE AND OBEY EVERY WORD IT SAYS. Read the bible with full confidence God is speaking to you through it, and obey what it says. We should be excited to know we hold the pure word of God in our hands and that God is trying to speak to us through it. So read it daily, and obey what it says to do!

2. Also, thank God for all he has done to keep his word for us to have today. We should be thankful for this everyday!

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A. Our verses are in Psalm chapter 12, verses 6 and 7

1. ***"The words of the Lord are pure words: as silver tried in a furnace of earth, purified seven times. Thou shalt keep them, O Lord, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."***

II. "The words of the Lord are pure words"

A. First it is important to mention that when this says "the words of the Lord" it is talking about the Bible. The Bible is God's Word to us, it is how he talks with us.

B. What does the word pure mean?

1. Pure- "perfect, clean, flawless (no flaws in it)"
2. **HOOK-** Now to demonstrate what the word pure means I brought 2 cups of water and this cup of dirt from my yard
    a) Water cup 1 is the word of God
    b) Water cup 2 is the word of God
    c) The dirt represents the ways that the devil tries to attack the word of God and dirty it up. Subtracting to it, adding to it, and changing what it says wherever he can.
    d) Now is this a cup of water? NO! It has water, but it also contains dirt. What we would call this now is MUD!! Not water. This (glass 1) is clean, fresh, and PURE water!

e) In this same way, when the word of God is changed, added to, or subtracted from, it may contain the words of God some places, but it is not the word of God. And you definitely wouldn't want to drink it!

III. "As silver tried in a furnace of earth"

A. Here, God compares his word to silver. Silver is a very precious and valuable metal that forms inside of the earth at very high temperatures.

B. The Bible is very precious to God, it is of very high value to him. So it should be to us as well!!!

IV. "Thou shalt keep them, O Lord, thou shalt preserve them from this generation for ever."

A. **KEEP-** To have in your possession in order to secure; to not lose or part with"

B. **PRESERVE**- To keep from destruction, or from corruption. To keep PURE, from decay.

C. Think of something you had that was very special to you. Maybe a really nice toy or game or present that you got. Think of how well you took care of it. Did you let it out of your sight? Did you know where it was at all times? Would you let it be broken or lost if you could help it at all?

D. GOD HIMSELF has taken the responsibility to take care of his word. He says here that he will keep them, he will protect them and keep them secure himself! And that he will preserve it, he will keep it from harm, for ever! The Bible is in good hands!

V. What do we do now?

A. We know that our Bible is the perfect and pure word of God. We know all the trouble God went through in order to keep and preserve it for us, and how important it is to him that we have it. So we MUST BELIEVE AND OBEY EVERY WORD IT SAYS. Read the bible with full confidence God is speaking to you through it, and obey what it says. We should be excited to know we hold the pure word of God in our hands and that God is trying to speak to us through it. So read it daily, and obey what it says to do!

B. Also, thank God for all he has done to keep his word for us to have today. We should be thankful for this everyday! Because God not only kept the bible pure, but he promised to preserve it, so that we could always have access to it and be able to hear from and walk with him.

KIDS CLASS EASTER 2ND GRADE 2021

1. Hand out class material (word symbol fill in)
2. Get apple tv hooked up and ready to use with video
3. Kids to music
4. Snack
    a. Pray
    b. Eat
    c. WATCH VIDEO AND EXPLAIN
5. LESSON PART 1 (no PPT yet)
    a. Jesus death (ask about good friday)
        i. Luke 23:32-48
6. LESSON PART 2 (pull up PPT)
    a. Jesus Resurrection
        i. Matt. 27:62- 28:10
7. GIVE THE GOSPEL AND EXPLAIN WHY THIS WAS ALL SO IMPORTANT (JESUS DEATH AND RESURRECTION)

MISSIONS CONFERENCE: SAINT PATRICK

LESSON THEME: ***"ANSWERING THE CALL OF GOD TO THE MISSION FIELD"***

I. HOOK:

A. Begin the lesson by giving the kids a brief overview of what will be taking place today. Something along the lines of **"In class today, we will be taking a look at a very famous missionary in history, his name is Patricius (Patrick), or as many of you may know him, Saint Patrick. (ask how many of the kids have heard of saint patrick)."**

B. From here you may also want to explain to the kids that there is a lot of confusion about who Patrick was, and there are many lies out there about who he was. Explain that Patrick wasn't really a saint in the way that the world and the Catholic Church try to say, but that he was a saint in the way the Bible explains because the Bible calls anybody who is saved and has been born again by the blood of Jesus a saint. Patrick was a true born again believer and missionary.

C. From here it may be a good idea to share with the kids the key verses we will be sticking to for this lesson. Read them to the kids, and tell them to think on the verses as they watch the life of Patrick on the video.

   1. **Acts 1:8; Matt. 28:19-20; ***Acts 16:9-12*****

D. Say something along the lines of “**Before we begin our lesson, let's first watch a quick video that will tell us a lot about Saint Patrick.”**

E. Accessing the video

1. Video URL

a) https://youtu.be/A6ZbN1R7Bos

2. OR type--- Saint Patrick explainED---- this should be the first video to come up, it is on Youtube, and it is 5:16 long. If this fails, typing the URL in exactly should work 100% of the time. But if all fails, I can share the link with whoever needs it. Just reach out to me and I can send it to you.

II. BOOK

A. **STUDY FOR THE TEACHER:** As a teacher, you will first want to come to class prepared knowing much of the story of Saint Patrick. Even the video we are showing to the class, while it does not have very much of a Catholic tint, it still does have some of one. However, then again, so did the life of Patrick because of where and when he grew up. Consider the following from the video:

1. Patrick had no access to the word of God fully as we do, this was only a few hundred years after Christ. With a pure heart, young, unlearned, and repentant, he had dreams to go and obey the command of God, which he otherwise had never heard. He never had dreams that told him contrary to the word of God.

2. He was called a bishop in Ireland. Not a priest or monk as many were at the time. He was a bishop, which is biblically a PASTOR!
3. The video calls out specifically that he was a church planter, NOT a church builder or some catholic held position not doing the work of the Lord.
4. He never in his writing mentions Holy mother Mary or baptism for salvation. He does specifically give credit to and call our that salvation is from the death, burial, and resurrection of Christ solely.
5. Although it is pointed out that his parents were “religious” it does not say that his conversion was that of repenting and realizing his parents were right all along, though he denied when he was young. He converted and repented and prayed to God for salvation, and he was a true born again believer!

B. FOR THE KIDS

1. Retell in a short manner the story of Patrick, explaining along the way whatever you feel needs explained to tell the kids what a true born again believer, missionary, church planting man Patrick was.
    a) Patrick was born in a place called Brittania in the United Kingdom. He was born into a “religious” family, his parents were clergy people in their churches (official church leaders). When he was very young, he was out working one day when Invaders from Ireland came and took him and many others to be slaves in Ireland. While he was in Ireland serving as a

shepherd he was very lonely. Many times Patrick did not have enough food or water to eat and drink, he was very cold, and did not have many clothes to wear. While he was working in the field as a shepherd he would pray many times a day, it took him being in these terrible situations to realize that there was a God and he knew he had rejected him for too long and it was time for him to get right. During this time Patrick prayed and repented of who he was and his sin, and believed in Jesus Christ for salvation. After this, one night Patrick had a dream where God was telling him there was a ship waiting for him about 200 miles away and that he should take it and flee back to his home. Patrick woke up and made the 200-mile journey to the shore and got on the boat that was waiting for him, and although they didn't want to let him on at first he was eventually allowed to board the ship and go. When Patrick returned home he eventually found and reunited with his family. After a while Patrick had another dream of somebody he knew from Ireland who was holding a stack of letters. On one of the letters Patrick read, “THE VOICE OF THE IRISH, WE APPEAL TO YOU, YOUNG HOLY BOY, TO COME AND WALK AMONG US”. This moment was the time that Patrick first felt the call to going to the mission field. He had a heart for the people of Ireland, the very people who took him captive

as a young 16 year old boy. After years of training in Bible School, Patrick finally made the voyage back to Ireland and became a missionary. The culture was full of idols, uncleanness, and ungodliness, but by the time Patrick died, the country had seen churches planted and many people leave their idols and ungodliness and repent and believe in Jesus Christ for salvation. (***THIS PART NEEDS TO BE SAID, AS IT WILL RELATE TO THE CRAFT FOR THIS LESSON**) *We all know that Saint Patrick's we relate to the color green, the Irish, and clovers. Why is this? This was actually because of a very creative thing Patrick did to share the gospel with people. Patrick would use 3 leaf plants which are found all over Ireland, in order to explain to people the Trinity. God is 3 parts and yet still 1 God. The Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost. This is where the tradition of wearing green and clovers all over the place on Saint Patrick's Day originated from. This may even be a great opportunity to share the gospel with others on Saint Patrick's day, explaining the history of the clover on the holiday to other people, and then using it to share the gospel with them.*

2. Take the kids to **Acts 16:9-12** again and read the story of Paul and his dream of the people of Macedonia calling for him to come to them. This story is very similar to the story of Patrick, they both

answered the call and we need to answer the call God had made to us.

III. LOOK

A. Here as teachers You're going to want to now bring the call to the mission field home for the students. If Patrick and Paul are are examples of people who answered the call to the mission field, then the students need to hear that same call in order to answer it.

B. Going back to our key passages

1. **Acts 1:8-** "**8** But ye shall receive power, after that the Holy Ghost is come upon you: and ye shall be witnesses unto me both in Jerusalem, and in all Judaea, and in Samaria, and unto the uttermost part of the earth."
2. **Matt. 28:19-20-** "Go ye therefore, and teach all nations, baptizing them in the name of the Father, and of the Son, and of the Holy Ghost: **20** Teaching them to observe all things whatsoever I have commanded you: and, lo, I am with you always, even unto the end of the world. Amen.
    a) Explain to the kids that in these passages we are told to go to all the world, preach the gospel, and make disciples. And all the while God is going to be with us!
    b) Because the Bible is God's word, when we read these commands to go, we can immediately apply these to

ourselves, God is calling YOU to GO, just like he did Patrick and Paul!

IV. TOOK

A. Here we need to really hit home with the students that they need to be in prayer and God's word to hear his direction on where, when, and to whom God is calling them to go to.
    1. Where is God calling you to? Where are there places with a lot of people that God has put in your life that you can reach?
    2. Who has God called you to? When you think of someone who you're close to, who comes to mind right now that you know you need to share Jesus with?
B. THIS IS YOUR MISSION FIELD, AND YOU HAVE BEEN CALLED TO IT
    1. Will you answer the call to the mission field God has given you, and called you to go to?
    2. You can be creative about it, just like Patrick. You can even use clovers to explain the trinity to people, or to explain the ABC's of salvation
C. What can you do THIS WEEK, to immediately answer this call?

V. LESSON CRAFT- Three Leaf Clover Gospel

A. Materials you will need
    1. 3 green heart cutouts
    2. 1 rectangle piece for stem

3. Admit, Believe, Call print outs (for older kids they can write out the ABCs on their clover leaves)
4. Brass fastener

B. How to assemble

1. Cut out three green hearts, template provided, and one rectangle stem
2. Line up all pieces in clover shape and fasten with brass fastener
3. Cut out Admit, Believe, Call statements and attach each one to a different clover leaf. Older kids can write out Admit, Believe, Call on each leaf and write what each step means!

VI. POTENTIAL LESSON REVIEW GAME

A. Lesson review jeopardy

1. For this game you can split into two teams. Boys vs. girls is easy to do, but you can split however you want. From here your going to want to draw the jeopardy board on the board, and make the number categories.

a)



2. Once you have the board drawn, consider explaining to the kids how the game works. In case anyone reading does not know, the basic idea is you pick a category and a wager. The amount you pick you will win if you get correct, and lose if you are wrong. The higher the wager the harder the question. Once a category is picked and a wager, cross it off. You play until all squares have been used. If for some reason there is a tie, or a close match. You may feel free to do a final question where the teams can decide to wager as much or as little as they would like, up to the amount of points the team has. After the question is answered, again, you may win or lose the points wagered, depending on if you gave the correct answer or not.

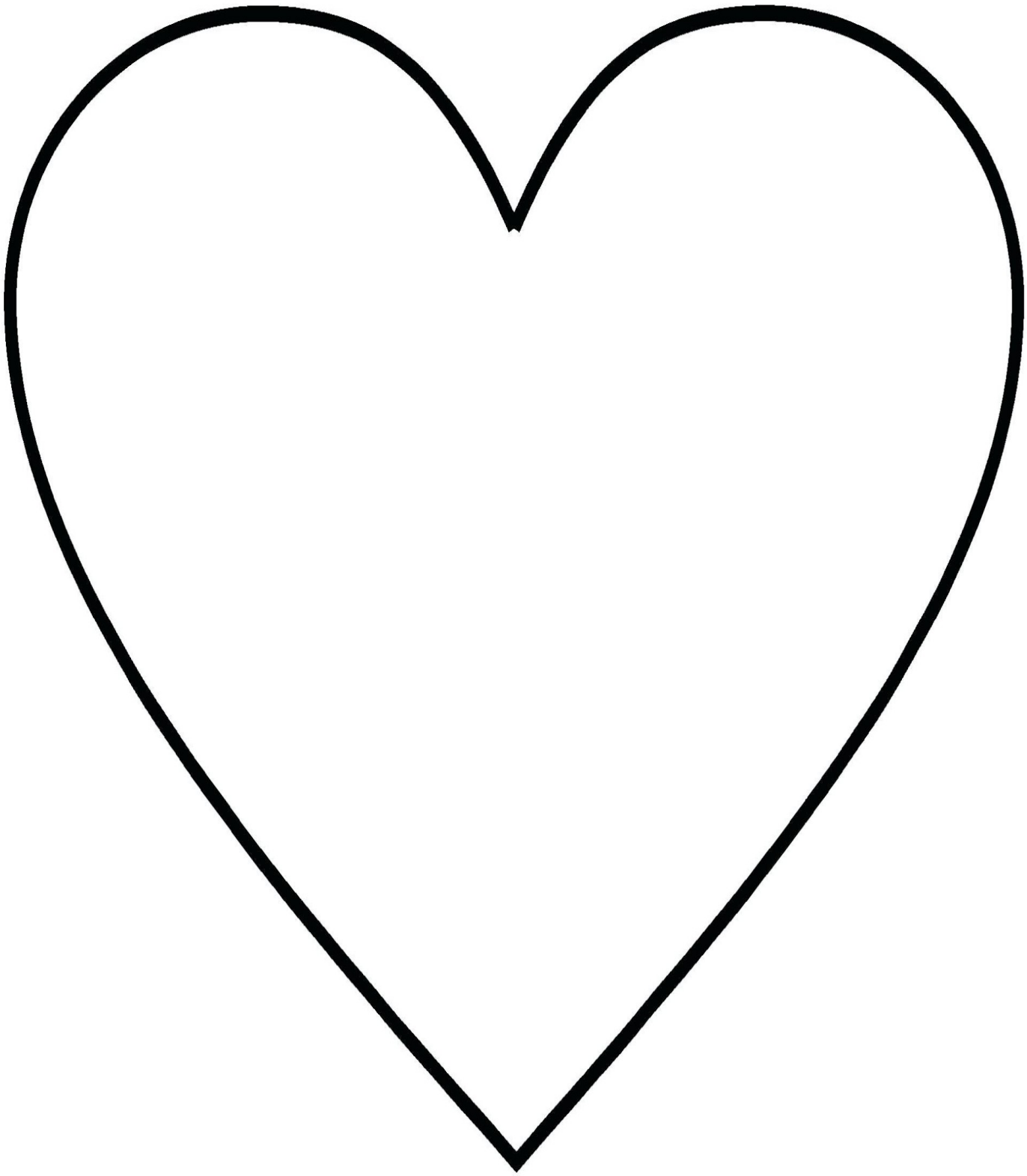
3. I play this game with 1st and 2nd grade often. They get the idea of the game, and it is their favorite game to play!

B. Potential jeopardy categories

1. The life of Patrick
2. Finish the verse (fill in the missing word in the verse)
3. Random facts about Patrick
4. The ministry of Patrick

C. Potential jeopardy questions

1. Where was Patrick born
2. About when was patrick born
3. What were Patrick's parents? Their jobs?
4. How old was Patrick when he was kidnapped?
5. Who was Patrick captured and enslaved by?
6. What county was Patrick taken to, to be a slave?
7. How many dreams did Patrick claim to have from God?
8. What did Patrick do special with clovers?
9. What did our story tell us Patrick planted all across Ireland?
10. What job did Patrick have when he was first enslaved?
11. Where was Patrick when he first had a dream from God?
12. What age/when did Patrick get saved?
13. Why did Patrick go back to Ireland after getting back home to the UK?
14. ETC….



ADMIT

You are a sinner

BELIEVE

That Jesus died on the

Cross and rose again

CALL

Out to God and ask

Him to save you



Teacher: Luke Johnston
Wed PM (11/30/22)

I. The issues of depression and anxiety are becoming more and more prevalent today than they have ever been. With the increase in the world of materialism, pride, selfishness, bad news, tragedy, mistrust, etc… it can easily become overwhelming even for Christians. The good news is that the word of God speaks expressly on this _____ of life. God has given us very clear signs in his word as to how depression can happen, how to avoid it, and how to deal with it when it inevitably comes to us. Today we will examine exactly what God has to say on this issue and how to handle it.

II. What is Depression/Anxiety?

A. **Depression/Anxiety** according to Websters 1828

1. The act of pressing down; or the state of being pressed down; a low state.
2. The act of humbling; abasement; as the depression of pride; the depression of the nobility.
3. A sinking of the spirits; dejection; a state of sadness; want of courage or animation; as depression of the mind.
4. In medical language, uneasiness; unceasing restlessness in sickness.

B. **Depression/Anxiety according to the Bible**

1. Proverbs 12:25- Heaviness in the heart of man maketh it **stoop**: but a good word maketh it glad.
2. Psalm 38:6- I am troubled; I am **bowed down** greatly; I go **mourning** all the day long.
3. Psalm 42:11- Why art thou **cast down**, O my soul? and why art thou **disquieted** within me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.

III. What can cause Depression/Anxiety according to the _____?

A. Sin/Pride- Psalm 38:1-10; Luke 14:11; Isa. 14:12-20

B. Investing wholly in wordly, temporary, vain things- Ecc. 1:16-18; Matt. 16:26

C. Hard times/circumstances- 1 Sam. 1:7,10; Job 3:11; 1 Kings 19:4

IV. How do we deal with Depression/Anxiety according to the Bible?

A. Cast all our cares to our Lord in prayer

1. Phil 4:6-7 ;1 Pet. 5:7; Psalm 55:22; 1 Sam. 1:11; 1 Kings 19:5-8,12,18; **Matt. 26:38-39**

B. Fasting

1. 1 Sam. 1:8; 2 Sam. 12:15-16; Matt. 17:21

C. Faithfully search the scriptures and obey what God is telling you to do

1. Prov. 16:3; Matt. 11:28-30

V. Should I take _____ for my Depression/Anxiety?

A. We have looked at exactly what the Bible says about these issues and dealing with these issues. The short answer is, yes, you can; but you may not necessarily have to
B. There is no substitute for the Bible's prescription for these issues. The steps we looked at are irreplaceable. They can however have medication mixed with them. Whatever decision we make needs to be **BY FAITH**.
C. Col. 2:6; Hebrews 11:6; Romans 10:17; Romans 14:23; Prov. 3:5-7
D. The only way to answer this question will be through the steps mentioned above of spending time in prayer and the word of God. This will direct your decision and show you exactly what you ought to do **BY FAITH**! If God is showing you that you ought to take medication, then you better do exactly that **BY FAITH**! It's by faith because you acknowledged him and now trust he is directing your paths.
E. It is key to remember and BELIEVE BY FAITH what the Bible tells us in Mark 10:27- ***And Jesus looking upon them saith, With men it is impossible, but not with God: for with God all things are possible.***

VI. As we have seen today, this issue of depression/anxiety is clearly spoken about in the word of God. Many people in the Bible dealt with it to varying degrees, just as many of us do. All of us in some way and at some time will deal with it, and when we do, we must turn to what God tells us to do to handle it. The only 100% sure way to handle it is with God. There is no _____ for exercising faith through prayer and the reading of the word of God when we are faced with this issue of life.



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3. Psalm 42:11- Why art thou **cast down**, O my soul? and why art thou **disquieted** within me? hope thou in God: for I shall yet praise him, who is the health of my countenance, and my God.
    a) The theme we see with depression/anxiety is that they are equated with bringing us down and pressing down on us. No doubt this is what the devil wants us to feel. He is a roaring lion seeking to DEVOUR us and to do that, he has to bring us down (just as he was brought down)
    b) I didn't have time to really dive into this tonight but there is a great correlation in the Bible with pride/humility and depression/being exalted & joyful

III. What can cause Depression/Anxiety according to the **Bible**?

A. Sin/Pride- Psalm 38:1-10; Luke 14:11; Isa. 14:12-20

B. Investing wholly in wordly, temporary, vain things- Ecc. 1:16-18; Matt. 16:26

1. Solomon the richest and wisest man to ever live, had all that you could want by the worlds standards; riches, power, wisdom, etc… and yet when he was wholly given to these things and not submitted to the Lord, he was depressed. That is the mood of the whole book of Ecclesiastes, ALL IS VAIN, according to the man who had it all, except to fear the Lord and keep his commandments!

2. Think about the nature of investing in temporary, worldly, vain things: they are not valuable. They will perish, they will change, they will let you down, you will lose them, they won't satisfy you. Only God, who offers eternal, spiritual, godly joy can fulfill you completely. All else is vain! They will lead to sorrow.

3. America is the 2nd most depressed country by prevalence in the world!

C. Hard times/circumstances- 1 Sam. 1:7,10; Job 3:11; 1 Kings 19:4

1. We can all experience these times of extreme sorrow, hurt, fear, and loss that can lead us to a place where we weep for days, wish we were never born, or wish we were dead.
2. It's certainly something nobody wants to talk about, but also certainly something we all feel at times to some degree or another. We can have these feelings. Life is hard. We just cannot allow ourselves to stay in these places when the Bible promises peace, joy, and lightness to those who know/walk with the Lord.

IV. How do we deal with Depression/Anxiety according to the Bible?

A. Cast all our cares to our Lord in prayer

1. Phil 4:6-7 ;1 Pet. 5:7; Psalm 55:22; 1 Sam. 1:11; 1 Kings 19:5-8,12,18; **Matt. 26:38-39**

B. Fasting

1. 1 Sam. 1:8; 2 Sam. 12:15-16; Matt. 17:21

C. Faithfully search the scriptures and obey what God is telling you to do

1. Prov. 16:3; Matt. 11:28-30
   a) We so often are very quick to take on the cumbersome "yokes" of the world but very hesitant to believe God by faith when he says that his yoke is light. We will still have a "yoke" (be involved in work) but it's a good yoke. When we stop clinging to the things of this world and we simply commit ourselves to the work of the Lord, he establishes our thoughts and our burdens are made light.

V. Should I take **medication** for my Depression/Anxiety?

A. We have looked at exactly what the Bible says about these issues and dealing with these issues. The short answer is, yes, you can; but you may not necessarily have to

B. There is no substitute for the Bible's prescription for these issues. The steps we looked at are irreplaceable. They can however have medication mixed with them. Whatever decision we make needs to be **BY FAITH**.

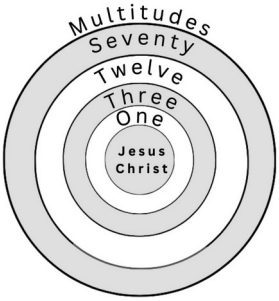
C. Col. 2:6; Hebrews 11:6; Romans 10:17; Romans 14:23; Prov. 3:5-7

D. The only way to answer this question will be through the steps mentioned above of spending time in prayer and the word of God. This will direct your decision and show you exactly what you ought to do **BY FAITH**! If God is showing you that you ought to take medication, then you better do exactly that **BY FAITH**! It's by faith because you acknowledged him and now trust he is directing your paths.

1. All situations of depression/anxiety are not the same. They range from temporary and mild to long term and severe. Most cases we are talking about will never require medication, they are simple cases that come and go. This would be a serious consideration for someone with something more long term and severe.

E. It is key to remember and BELIEVE BY FAITH what the Bible tells us in Mark 10:27- ***And Jesus looking upon them saith, With men it is impossible, but not with God: for with God all things are possible.***

VI. As we have seen today, this issue of depression/anxiety is clearly spoken about in the word of God. Many people in the Bible dealt with it to varying degrees, just as many of us do. All of us in some way and at some time will deal with it, and when we do, we must turn to what God tells us to do to handle it. The only 100% sure way to handle it is with God. There is no **substitute** for exercising faith through prayer and the reading of the word of God when we are faced with this issue of life.

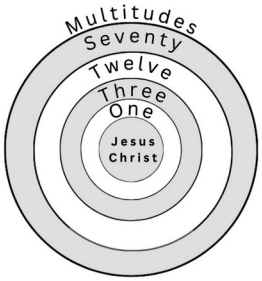


Close to Christ

Today we will examine the different types of disciples we see in the Bible. Though there are many disciples, each one chooses how close they will be to Jesus, and each experiences a different level of intimacy with Him. We would all say we want to be close to Christ, but the truth is that not all of us are willing to do what it takes to make that happen. By the end of today's lesson, it will be clear what it means to be a disciple who is not merely following Jesus, but _____ to Him than the rest.

1) There are different levels of closeness to Jesus amongst his disciples
   - **a) The** _____
     - i) They will be fed the word of God- Mark 6:34; 4:1-2; Luke 5:1; Matt. 13:1-3
     - ii) They will experience miracles- Matt. 12:15; 14:14; 15:30
     - iii) They enjoy the benefits of following Jesus- John 6:26
     - iv) They will walk away when things are tough- John 6:51-66
   - **b) The** _____
     - i) They will be involved in the work of the Lord. They will share his message and labor for him- Luke 10:1
     - ii) They will do miracles, not just experience them- Luke 10:17
     - iii) They will be entrusted with more than the "multitudes"- Romans 16:7
     - iv) While they truly desired to serve the Lord, they are seemingly not willing to do it once it costs them too much
   - **c) The** _____
     - i) They are given power to preach and do miracles on Jesus' behalf- Luke 9:1-2; Matt. 10:1, 7-8; Mark 3:13-15; Mk. 6:7, 12-13
     - ii) They are given special authority and power in eternity future for their service to God in this life- Matt. 19:28; Luke 22:28-30
     - iii) They are shown some special things by God that the multitudes and the seventy will never be shown. God reveals special truths to them- Matt. 13:10-11; Mark 4:33-34
     - iv) When things get tough, though they may falter for a time, ultimately they trust in God and pray, they don't run- Acts 1:13-14
     - v) They do great things with an eternal impact for the Lord and will impact multitudes (Matthew, John, James, 1 & 2 Peter, 1 & 2 & 3 John, Jude, Revelation)
     - vi) A small part of these 12 can be imposters and traitors- Matt. 26:47; Mark 14:10
   - **d) The** _____
     - i) They will see the true full power and glory of Jesus in ways that nobody else will- Matt. 17:1-9
     - ii) Jesus depends on them and desires to have them near to him- Matt. 26:36-38; Mk. 14:33-34
     - iii) They will see amazing miracles that even the other 12 will never see- Luke 8:49-56; Mk. 5:37-43
   - **e) The** _____
     - i) They are so close to Jesus they KNOW they would never betray him; they have no doubt- John 13:23-25; Matt. 26:22
     - ii) They will never walk away from Jesus. At risk of their life, they will be with him all the way to the end, even when everyone else is gone- John 19:26
     - iii) God will show them unimaginable, amazing things that others will never understand. He reveals all truth to them and holds nothing back- Rev. 1:9-11; 10:4

As we have seen today, there are many different levels to how closely we can walk with God. All these people we have examined today were true disciples of Jesus, but not all disciples are the same. We can be as close to God as we desire to be, all we must do is make the choices that will make that possible. These are not easy choices but are well worth the amazing life that awaits when you are _____ _____ disciple among many disciples of Jesus Christ. *James 4:8- "Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you..."*



Close to Christ

1) Today we will examine the different types of disciples we see in the Bible. Though there are many disciples, each one chooses how close they will be to Jesus, and each experiences a different level of intimacy with Him. We would all say we want to be close to Christ, but the truth is that not all of us are willing to do what it takes to make that happen. By the end of today's lesson, it will be clear what it means to be a disciple who is not merely following Jesus, but **CLOSER** to Him than the rest.

2) There are different levels of closeness to Jesus amongst his disciples (CONSIDER TODAY; 'WHERE ARE YOU AT IN THIS LIST? HOW CLOSE TO CHRIST ARE YOU REALLY?"

a) The Multitudes

i) They will be fed the word of God (Mark 6:34; 4:1-2; Luke 5:1; Matt. 13:1-3)

(1) There will be many people who here about/of the teachings of Christ. They have heard the gospel, heard the bible; yet what they do with it differs greatly

ii) They will experience miracles (Matt. 12:15; 14:14; 15:30)

(1) Miracle of salvation (WHAT A MIRACLE THAT IS), miracle of answered prayer, a changed life, etc.

iii) They enjoy the benefits of following Jesus (John 6:26)

iv) They will walk away when things are tough (John 6:51-66)

(1) They are following for miracles, the benefits of following Jesus, and for physical provision, but when the truth of the word of God is preached, and they have to make a hard decision for him, they stumble at it and fall away

(2) Are you following Jesus because it gives you a place to hangout? Because you want him to answer your prayers ONLY for your physical needs? When the word of God is preached it divides (Heb. 4:12), which side will you be on? Do you give it the benefit of the doubt?

v) They only follow for themselves and are not willing to sacrifice

(1) When things are hard at all they are gone. They won't follow Jesus to his/their death

(2) When Jesus says something they don't like, they are gone

(3) When he calls them out for only living selfishly and not actually to follow him, they are gone

(4) If you are only following for your own benefit; and not out of true Faith, trust, and love for Jesus Christ, then you are in danger of leaving following him when he says/does things you don't like

vi) Notice the response of the twelve (John 6:67-69)

(1) They don't say "we fully understand everything that you just said. They say, "we know who you are! The Christ! Because of that, even if we don't get it yet, we believe you."

(a) Giving the word of God the benefit of the doubt, is a key to God opening its understanding to you!

(b) Later on, Jesus expounds on this teaching at the Lords supper, and the twelve disciples come to understand it, unlike those who walked away here. They didn't want to believe it, they weren't really following Jesus.

(c) Man says, "Show me and I will believe."; God says, "Believe and I will show you."

(d) ALSO NOTE: this is where the MOST "followers" walk away. More than 5,000 were at the feeding with the fishes and loaves (Matt. said it didn't include women and children), and so thousands walk away here. Hard sayings from the Bible

b) The Seventy

i) They will be involved in the work of the Lord. They will share his message and labor for him (Luke 10:1)

(1) Maybe this is you, you have taken it a step further than experiencing the miracles, being fed, and being taught the word of God; you actually serve the Lord in some capacity

ii) They will do miracles, not just experience them (Luke 10:17)

(1) Leading someone to the Lord, discipling someone to walk closer with God, being conformed to the image

of Jesus Christ through the reading of the word of God and prayer, these are all miracles!! Have you experienced miracles in your life?

iii) They will be entrusted with more than the "multitudes"

(1) These become "sent forth ones" (apostles), given authority and ability to do things that almost nobody else gets to do (Romans 16:7)

iv) While they truly desired to serve the Lord, they are seemingly not willing to do it once it costs them too much

(1) As Jesus ministry progressed toward the cross, pressure and persecution built more and more. Things got harder and as we will see, the disciples that follow Jesus dwindle. These 70 are not mentioned outside of here in Luke

(2) We aren't told for certain what happens to these seventy (12 remained) but some potential things could be:

(a) They feared what would happen to their family

(b) They didn't like the ridicule they received from those they shared Jesus message with

(c) They feared what would happen to their business (nobody would want to do business with some radicals following a radical teacher who was hated)

(d) They feared that they may lose their lives

(e) They realized they didn't have time to follow him EVERYWHERE he went because they had other things they were involved in. They had friends, activities, family, jobs, all good stuff that there was nothing wrong with. They weren't willing to give it up. THEY WEREN'T WILLING TO LEAVE THEIR NETS OR LEAVE FATHER AND MOTHER AS THE 12 WERE

(f) They weren't willing to obey the "radical" things he was asking them to do (forgive others, be in ministry with tax collectors and sinners, share his message that the kingdom was coming, seek FIRST his kingdom and allow God to take care of your physical needs, etc…)

(g) They weren't willing to let go of sin in their lives and simply felt unworthy to follow Jesus any further or share his message anymore

c) The Twelve

i) They are given power to preach and do miracles on Jesus behalf (Luke 9:1-2; Matt. 10:1, 7-8; Mark 3:13-15; Mk. 6:7, 12-13)

ii) They are given special authority and power in eternity future for their service to God in this life (Matt. 19:28; Luke 22:28-30)

(1) You have this same ability to have this in eternity, but only if you are walking close to God like this. If you aren't a part of the "12" you won't be trusted with heavenly responsibility because he couldn't trust you with earthly responsibility

(2) When you have followed Christ this far, you will receive responsibility and reward in heaven that others simply won't

(3) The "judgment seat of Christ" is real, that day is coming. We will be "judged" on that day, and if we have fainted before we got to this point with Christ, we will "suffer loss" (1 Cor. 3:15)

iii) They are shown some special things by God that the multitudes and the seventy will never be shown. God reveals special truths to them (Matt. 13:10-11; Mark 4:33-34)

(1) Do you wonder why you don't feel that you see the amazing, deeper things of the word of God that others seem to? God shows more and more as we go along to those who are closest to him. The more you draw close to him, he will draw closer to you (***James 4:8- Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you. Cleanse your hands, ye sinners; and purify your hearts, ye double minded***.)

iv) When things get tough, though they may falter for a time, ultimately they trust in God and pray, they don't run (Acts 1:13-14)

v) They do great things with an eternal impact for the Lord and will impact multitudes (Matthew, John, James, 1 & 2 Peter, 1 & 2 & 3 John, Jude, Revelation)

(1) These books were written by some of these 12 disciples and they will last for eternity and they have helped and impacted billions of people

vi) A small part of these 12 can be imposters and traitors (Matt. 26:47; Mark 14:10)

(1) It can be very easy to fake all of these things, but only for a season. Some that appear to be a part of this twelve will experience miracles, do miracles, be shown special revelation by God, etc… and yet they were

faking it all along and they betray him

(a) At this level of discipleship you are following God in true charitable love for him. You cannot have this type of intimate relationship to God when you are just obeying on duty alone. Dutiful obedience is fine, but will only take you so far.

(b) A good question to ask yourself at this point, "why am I following?"

(c) Its good that you are following him, but the "why" becomes important. Many believe that Judas was disappointed that Jesus was not the "conquering king messiah" that he expected him to be. Some believe he turned Jesus in to try and force his hand to rebel against Rome and takeover.

(d) REFER TO OTHER PAPER

(e) Whatever his reason was, we need to be careful of our reasons for following Christ. He is the Lord, our Master; not us. If we have expectations for what he should do, how things should go, we may be sorely disappointed and walk away even at this level.

(f) Even a "good desire" (Judas desire for Jesus kingdom was biblical and good); but not on God's timing, following him wherever he leads, whenever he leads, can be DETRIMENTAL

d) The Three

i) These would be Peter, James, and John

ii) They will see the true full power and glory of Jesus in ways that nobody else will (Matt. 17:1-9)

(1) There are many disciples who will serve and follow Jesus as far as he will take them but these 3 desired to KNOW HIM above all else. If you desire to know God like this, you will spend more time in his word and more time in prayer with him than anyone else. You only get to know Jesus the living Word this well through the written word. These disciples will see his glory and power in ways that so few will

iii) Jesus depends on them and desires to have them near to him (Matt. 26:36-38; Mk. 14:33-34)

(1) Would it hurt God's heart if you walked away? Do you have such a deep relationship with him that he desires for you to be the one near to him when things are hard? When the world is rejecting him, walking away from God, refusing to believe in him and thousands are heading to hell each day, does he look forward to his time with you, his faithful disciple he can count on

iv) They will see amazing miracles that even the other 12 will never see (Luke 8:49-56; Mk. 5:37-43)

(1) Here Jesus invites ONLY these 3 to come and see this miracle of him raising from the dead the daughter of Jairus. He then tells them not to tell ANYONE else what they have seen.

(2) Again, the closer you are to him, the further you follow him, the more he shows you.

e) The One

i) **This is John, the beloved disciple; we all should strive to be in this place**

ii) They are so close to Jesus they KNOW they would never betray him; they have no doubt (John 13:23-25; Matt. 26:22)

(1) Also notice, that the other disciples, even among the closest 3, knew who was the closest to Christ. Peter asks John to ask Jesus.

(2) John does not ask, "is it I?" he asks "who is it?" HE KNOWS IT IS NOT HIM

iii) They will never walk away from Jesus. At risk of their life they will be with him all the way to the end, even when everyone else is gone (John 19:26)

(1) At this point, all others are gone. Even Peter, one of the 3, at this point had denied Jesus for fear of his own life. But John goes with him all the way to the cross

iv) God will show them unimaginable, amazing things that others will never understand. He reveals all truth to them and holds nothing back (Rev. 1:10-11; 10:4)

(1) John was shown "The Revelation of Jesus Christ" (first 5 words of the book)

(2) Many see this book as a book all about the end times, prophesy, judgement, etc.. AND ALL ARE TRUE. **But the Theme, and message of the book is all about "revealing Jesus Christ: who he is, his Glory, his Kingdom, his Judgement, his People, and his Ultimate Victory and Throne**

(3) John was shown things hidden to even us at this very day (thunders). It is between him and God alone.

3) As we have seen today, there are many different levels to how closely we can walk with God. All of these people we have examined today were true disciples of Jesus, but not all disciples are the same. We can be as close to God as we desire to be, all we must do is make the choices that will make that possible. These are not easy choices but are well worth the amazing life that awaits when you are **the one** disciple among many disciples of Jesus Christ (*James 4:8- Draw nigh to God, and he will draw nigh to you..."*

What do you need to do today to go further in your closeness to Christ? What do you need to sacrifice? What is standing between you and this level of intimacy/closeness to Jesus Christ?



Fundamentals of the Faith

I. Today we will be looking at an overview of the fundamentals of the Christian life. When it comes to sports, music, academics, and anything else we do in life, we all know the _____ of having the fundamentals down perfectly. The best people at all of these things know and can do these fundamentals with ease. We want to examine what the fundamentals of the Christian life are and how we can do them and live our lives successfully for God.

II. What is the Goal?

A. Bring glory to God (John 15:8; 1 Cor. 6:20)

1. **1 Cor. 10:31-** ***Whether therefore ye eat, or drink, or whatsoever ye do, do all to the glory of God.***

III. Time to _____

A. Prayer (James 1:5; 5:16; Psalm 10:17; James 4:8)

1. **Psalm 145:18-** ***The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth.***

B. The word of God (1 Thess. 2:13; Heb. 4:12; Eph. 5:26; James 1:22-25)

1. **John 17:17-** ***Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.***

IV. Game Time

A. Evangelism- (Matthew 28:19; 2 Cor. 5:18; 2 Tim. 4:5)

1. **Mark 16:15-** ***And he said unto them, Go ye into all the world, and preach the gospel to every creature.***

B. Discipleship- (Matt. 28:20; 2 Tim. 4:2; Eph. 4:12; 1 Cor. 14:12)

1. **2 Tim 2:2-** ***And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.***

V. The Other _____

A. The WORLD – John 17:10, 12-15; James 4:4

1. Be careful what you are consuming

B. The FLESH – Romans 7:24

C. The DEVIL – 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 22:31-32



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III. Time to Train

A. Prayer (James 1:5; 5:16; Psalm 10:17; James 4:8)

1. **Psalm 145:18-** ***The LORD is nigh unto all them that call upon him, to all that call upon him in truth.***
2. Prayer must come first! Prayer gets your heart right to seek God, it sets the tone for reading his word and listening for God's response to your prayers. If you ask him to speak to you he will.

B. The word of God (1 Thess. 2:13; Heb. 4:12; Eph. 5:26; James 1:22-25)

1. **John 17:17-** ***Sanctify them through thy truth: thy word is truth.***

a) The place where you are going to do the most training and learn to train yourself for the rest of your life is discipleship. If you are looking for answers, you feel you don't have the answers and you don't know the Bible and you don't know how to pray and how to really have a relationship with God, this is where you will learn it! Get discipled! This is your sign, it is the first thing the first step you need to take for things to start making sense!

IV. Game Time

1. There are only two ministries, two things we are called to do in this life! All other things fall under these categories. This is because there are only 2 types of people in the world today and each is a ministry to one or the other!

B. Evangelism- (Matthew 28:19; 2 Cor. 5:18; 2 Tim. 4:5)

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C. Discipleship- (Matt. 28:20; 2 Tim. 4:2; Eph. 4:12; 1 Cor. 14:12)

1. **2 Tim 2:2-** ***And the things that thou hast heard of me among many witnesses, the same commit thou to faithful men, who shall be able to teach others also.***
2. All of your Christian life you should be involved in sharing the gospel or building up/helping other Christians along in their Christian lives by helping them, edifying them, teaching them, comforting them, etc… all a part of discipleship!

V. The Other Team

A. The WORLD – John 17:10, 12-15; James 4:4
   1. This is the "way of the world". It tries to get you to think how it thinks, feel how it feels, and compromise and be apart of it
   2. Be careful what you are consuming

B. The FLESH – Romans 7:24
   1. Your daily battle against your flesh. Your bodily desires (laziness, lust, coveting, jealousy, etc..) What feels good to you!

C. The DEVIL – 1 Peter 5:8; Luke 22:31-32
   1. He is the power behind it all. He is using the world, to get your flesh to desire more and lust more. He uses the world and the flesh both with one another to get you to fall. He wants to see your life miserable.

GOD MOVES SATAN COUNTERS

As we have seen in this class, looking back at history with a biblical understanding and worldview, can make history become clear as to the work of God and the countering of the devil. What can be hard at times is to clearly see this struggle taking place in real time, and even more difficult to estimate how it will play out into the future. However, with a clear understanding of history and with a heart of belief in the word of God, we can see the future clearly. God has always been in the business of giving his people prophesies to know what is coming. While we may not know the exact details, we can have a good idea of what is coming, especially with where we are located in history. As events unfold, times goes on, and we get closer to the end, it is easier to interpret history, see the Bible come true, and ultimately to understand what may come next. This is what we will attempt to look at this morning.

I. **Signs** of the Times
   a. One of our greatest "sign of the times" is Israel- Pro. 27:18; Matt. 24:32-34; Song of Sol 2:10-13
      i. People often look around for all sorts of different signs (heavens, stars, eclipses, etc..) but we know the signs to look for, and the greatest sign/miracle occurred less than 100 years ago when Israel became a nation after almost 2000 years!

II. Following Israel in **Recent** History
   a. **WW1**- Where God is establishing a growing movement of "Zionism" in the world of people who support a Jewish State, the Devil is trying to create world war, killings, confusion, and world takeover through the Central Powers. God then uses WW1 as an opening for the land to be given back to Israel through the Balfour Declaration.
      i. At this time, Israel was spread around the world. There were pockets of Jewish people in the Russian empire (Ukraine, Belarus, and Lithuania; the majority of Jews during this time), Central Europe (Germany, the Austro-Hungarian empire), Western Europe (France and Britain), and a small population in the Ottoman Empire area of Palestine.
      ii. A Jewish scientist during WW1 helped to develop a method for producing Acetone which was crucial to the making of smokeless gunpowder which Britain needed to help win the war. For his contributions, he had contact with high ranking British officials such as David Lloyd George and Arthur Balfour which he leveraged to push for a homeland for the Jewish people.
         1. Their were others in the "Zionist" movement who were in positions to try and push for this as well during this time. God's people believing and acting on biblical prophesies has been a part of what God has used to enact these plans in the past (Daniel and Cyrus)
   b. WW2- When the Devil was trying to take over the world through Germany and a picture of the antichrist in Adolph Hitler, and to exterminate the Jews from off the face of the planet, God is using it to bring Israel back home to their land and solidify Israel as a sovereign state
      i. During this time, Jews were still largely spread out around the world even though many more moved to the British controlled but Jewish recognized area of Palestine. The holocaust and atrocities the Jews faced in WW2 lead to the Jewish people being led to go back home to their land. The UN Partition Plan Resolution 181 proposed a Jewish State, Arab State, and Jerusalem as a UN controlled international city. On May 14, 1948 Israel declared independence as a sovereign state.
      ii. **Clarence Larkin**- We have a great example of a Bible believer who read and believed the word of God, studied prophesy, and had a good idea of events soon to transpire around him. In 1918 he finished his work "Dispensational Truth" (21 years before WW2 began)
      iii. a. Gathered Back UNCONVERTED- "I will take you from among the heathen, and gather you out of all countries, and will bring you into your own land. **THEN will I sprinkle clean water upon you,** and ye shall be clean: from all your filthiness, and from all your idols will I cleanse you. A **New Heart** also will I give you, and a **New Spirit** will I put within you: and I will give you an **Heart of Flesh.** And I will put **My Spirit within you,** and cause you to walk in my statutes; and ye shall keep my judgments, and do **them.'** Ezek. 36:24-26.
      iv. b. Before Conversion They Are To Be JUDGED. "I will bring you out from the people, and will gather you out of the countries wherein ye are scattered, with a mighty hand, and with a stretched out

arm, and with **fury poured out.** And I will bring you into the wilderness of the people, and there will 1 plead with you face to face. And I will cause you to **'Pass Under The Rod, '** and I will bring you into the bond of the Covenant; and I will **purge out from among you the rebels,** and them that **transgress against Me: I** will bring them forth out of the country where they sojourn, and they shall **not enter into the Land of Israel.''** Eze. 20:34-36. Then God will cast them into His **'Melting Pot.'** "Therefore thus saith the Lord God; Because ye are all become **dross,** behold, therefore I will gather you into the **midst of Jerusalem.** As they gather silver, and brass, and iron, and lead, and tin. into the midst of the furnace, to blow the fire upon it, to melt it; so **will I gather you in mine anger and in My fury and I will leave you there, and MELT YOU.** Yea I will gather you. and blow upon you in the fire of my wrath, and ye shall be I **melted in the midst thereof.** As silver is melted in- the midst of the furnace, **so shall ye be melted in the midst thereof;** and ve shall know that I the Lord have poured out my fury upon you." Eze. 22:19-21.

c. **War the day after Israel's declaration-** After God has solidified Israel back as a nation in their land for the first time in almost 2000 years, the Devil uses Israels enemies to try and strike the young and weak Israel the following day. God uses this to expand Israel's land and establish their new place in this land.
    i. The next day, five Arab states (**Egypt, Jordan, Syria, Iraq, Lebanon**) invaded Israel, alongside Palestinian Arab forces. The war, known as the **1948 Arab-Israeli War**, lasted until early 1949. Israel not only defended its sovereignty but also expanded its territory, securing **78% of Mandatory Palestine**, including western Jerusalem.

d. **Six-Day War**- The Devil uses lies and confusion to try to destroy Israel again as a nation, Israel gets wind of this and preemptively strikes her enemies. Through MIRACULOUS victories God used this for Israel to expand her land and gain full control of Jerusalem for the first time in 2000 years.
    i. In May 1967, the Soviet Union erroneously informed Egypt that Israel was massing troops on the Syrian border, preparing for an imminent attack. This misinformation heightened regional tensions. In June 1967, facing imminent attacks by neighboring states, Israel launched a preemptive strike, defeating Egypt, Jordan, and Syria within six days.
    ii. **Miracle stories during this war**:
        1. There were reports of enemy shells hitting Israeli munitions but failing to detonate, preventing potential disasters.
        2. An Israeli infantry recruit recounted encountering a truck with 18 armed Egyptian soldiers. Despite being outnumbered and under-armed, the Israeli soldiers were able to capture the Egyptians without resistance. An Egyptian sergeant later explained that his body became paralyzed, rendering him unable to act.
        3. Gershon Salomon, a member of the Israel Defense Forces (IDF), recounted an incident where he lay wounded on the battlefield, facing imminent capture by Syrian soldiers. He reported that the Syrians suddenly fled, leaving their weapons behind. Later, it was revealed that the Syrian soldiers claimed to have seen "thousands of angels" surrounding the injured Israeli soldiers, prompting their retreat.

e. **Israel-Hamas War**- God moved Red Heifers to Israel for the purification for the temple to be rebuilt. Shortly after this occurred, Hamas attached Israel on October 7, 2023 at the influence of the Devil. What is God's next move?
    i. In September 2022, five red heifers were imported from Texas to Israel by a group of Jewish activists. The ashes of a red heifer are required for ritual purification, a prerequisite for rebuilding the Third Temple in Jerusalem. Hamas spokesman Abu Ubaydah stated that their attacks on October 7, 2024 were in response to the importation of the red heifers, viewing it as a provocation related to the Temple Mount.
    ii. **PHOTOS**

III. What is **next**?

a. Does America play a part in the rebuilding of the temple, the end times, the antichrist, etc…

b. Daniel's 4 Beast Prophesy and John's Vision of the Beast- Daniel 7:1-8 and Revelation 13:1-2

i. Historically these beasts "shall arise" out of the earth it says, and this was given during the reign of the final king of Babylon. The beasts historically were

1. Lion- Media-Persia
2. Bear- Greece
3. Leopard- Rome
4. 4th Beast- Antichrist Final kingdom (same as Revelation 13)

ii. However, this is seemingly a dual prophesy (common in the Bible) about other kingdoms that would show up directly before the antichrists final kingdom. The clue word is that he had the vision in the "night" (he says this 3 times). The night is used in the Bible as a picture of the church age

iii. Also, the only prophetic vision of Daniels that we see in the book of Revelation is this one from Daniel 7 where each of these beasts is mentioned. This would indicate that this prophesy also deals with the end times kingdoms directly leading into the antichrists final kingdom. None of his other visions are directly talked about in Revelation. To understand Daniel you need Revelation and to understand Revelation you need Daniel. To understand both and how they work in history, you need TIME to pass to see it clearer. We see clearer today than ever before!

1. **The Lion** prophetically talks about **Britain** (eagles wings plucked, is the young US being removed from Britain)
    a. Go to London, there are giant lion statues all over the place
2. **The Bear** prophetically talks about **Russia** (always associated with the bear, the Eurasian Brown Bear is the national animal of Russia)
3. **The Leopard** prophetically speaks of the **United States** in its fullest power today.
    a. The Leopard is a melting pot animal. It is yellow, black, and white which is representative of the US since its inception. It also has 4 heads which could be looked at a few ways: (major powers in America: President, Senate, House, Supreme Court, we often think of 3 powers but really the legislative branch is made up of 2 very important and powerful parts SOME people see it as the 3 branches of government and the 4th being the people or the media as the common saying goes)
    b. Look at the similarities in Rome and the US
    c. History Repeats itself! Just as God gave the details exactly of the kingdoms directly preceding his first coming, he also gave the details of the kingdoms directly preceding his 2nd coming!
    d. If these only represent the historical kingdoms before his first coming, then we can only assume that means the Beast of Revelation 13 and of Daniel 7 shows that the antichrists final kingdom will be a mix of: MEDIA PERSIA, GREECE, AND ANCIENT ROME
    e. That does not make sense! Persia no longer exists, Greek culture influences the world but the country is a non player, and Rome as a country does not have power/influence, they are IN MYSTERY FORM, working behind the scenes!!! (Rev. 17)

c. Understanding Americas place in the end, lets consider a few facts:

i. Order of the books

1. 2 Chronicles- Israel told to go home; Ezra/Nehemiah- Rebuilt temple, walls, and city; Ester- Rapture; Job- Tribulation (42 chapters/months of great tribulation); Psalms- Millennial Reign with David (Jesus Christ) as king with peace (selah)

ii. Israel and Trump

1. In 2017 President Trump recognized Jerusalem as the capital of Israel and moved our embassy to Jerusalem as a gesture of this statement, since this move many in Israel (especially the religious leaders) view Israel as a modern day Cyrus

a. He said, "I have determined that it is time to officially recognize Jerusalem as the capital of Israel."
b. He also called the move, ""a long-overdue **step** to advance the peace process and to work towards a lasting agreement."
c. **Historical Context:** President Trump referenced the **Jerusalem Embassy Act of 1995**, which called for the U.S. Embassy to be moved to Jerusalem but allowed presidents to issue waivers delaying the move for national security reasons. He noted that for over 20 years, previous presidents had exercised these waivers, but he chose to act on the legislation. (PBS)
d. The U.S. Embassy in Jerusalem officially opened on May 14, 2018, coinciding with the 70th anniversary of Israel's founding. The ceremony was attended by U.S. officials, including Ivanka Trump and Jared Kushner, and was met with both celebration and protest. (The Christian Post)
e. Since this time Israelis have compared Trump to Cyrus and have long thought he would be the one to rebuild the temple (hand coin around)

2. Trump has been hated, reviled, tried to be killed, tried to be jailed, tried to be impeached, had never before seen political maneuvers run against him, etc.. since he first won in 2016. The hate for him and the divine providence to keep him alive reads like the pages of a history book and the next chapter is God using him for a purpose. (VIDOES)
3. God used Trump to get that embassy to Jerusalem when presidents for over 20 years waived the Jerusalem Embassy Act to do so. Israel was attacked for bringing the heifers necessary to build the temple to Israel and started their longest and deadliest war yet (all while trump was out of office). Now he has the chance to come back into office, during a time of war in Israel, and create promised peace (he has already written peace treaties in the middle east).
4. Every major war in Israel, God has used for their furtherance and for moving us to the end. (this is their largest war yet)
    a. He has the man in place who Israel believes will do it and who the world/devil has seemingly desperately tried to keep out of office (the very thing they did to keep him out got him in- devil countering, God moving)
    b. He is in during the time to do it (major war in Israel) and has the courage to do it, the family and motivation to do it (senior advisor Jared Kushner is a Jew who influences these decisions)
    c. The Jewish people are more prepared for it now than ever (go home and check out the temple institute website, it is amazing to see)
5. His senior advisor Jewish son in law AUTHORED the **Abraham accords** (peace treaty in Israel) and led the brand new unit in the Trump administration called the "**Office of American Innovation**" to Advance Technological Innovation and to Integrate cutting-edge technologies into government processes.
6. It was through this office that Jared Kushner met Elon Musk, the famed innovator and businessman who:
    a. Is the richest man in the world ($**290B**)
    b. Involved in AI (**Tesla/ xAI**, also co-founded **OpenAI**, **ChatGPT**)
    c. Involved in cryptocurrency
    d. Involved in space travel (**Space X**)
    e. Involved in developing high-bandwidth brain-machine interfaces to connect the human brain with computers, with potential applications in treating neurological conditions and enhancing human cognition (**Neuralink**)
    f. Now will head up the new "**Government Efficiency Commission**" in the Trump administration to keep government spending under control

g. Is **associated with the letter X: X (used to be twitter), name of his son with the letter X (X Æ A-Xii), SpaceX, Tesla Model X, xAI, X.com (His first venture, was an online banking and financial services)**

7. **JD Vance, Donald Trump's VP is of course Catholic, but what kind of Catholic is he?**
   a. If you have read or know history, this sounds an awful lot like Jesuits. They have the same ideology and plot to infiltrate and use government to promote their way of thinking and religion.

iii. What does this all mean?
   1. If we look at history, believe the Bible, and try to interpret the events going on around us from a Biblical worldview (not political) then we can try and understand an idea of what may be coming next.
   2. Keeping an eye on Israel is key. Whether or not America is the main body of the antichrists kingdom or whether Trump will build the temple, we know that the end is nearer now than ever. We have to keep our eyes open, the word of God as our guide, and work like it's our last day, every day.

GOD MOVES SATAN COUNTERS

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        2. Every major war in Israel, God has used for their furtherance and for moving us to the end. (this is their largest war yet)
    iii. What does this all mean?
        1. If we look at history, believe the Bible, and try to interpret the events going on around us from a Biblical worldview (not political) then we can try and understand an idea of what may be coming next.
        2. Keeping an eye on Israel is key. Whether or not America is the main body of the antichrists kingdom or whether Trump will build the temple, we know that the end is nearer now than ever. We have to keep our eyes open, the word of God as our guide, and work like it's our last day, every day.

HIDING THE GOSPEL

Teacher: Luke Johnston

JBI 7 LAWS OF THE TEACHER MESSAGE (05/04/23)

1. **HOOK**- VIDEO

2. **BOOK**- **2 Corinthians 4:3-4**

3. **LOOK**-

   a. **This scenario is a perfect picture of the spiritual problems we see in the Bible**

      i. Our eyes are open and we have the news that can save someone from certain death

      ii. Their death is not only falling off of a cliff, but eternal death and separation from God for eternity in Hell (Romans 6:23)

      iii. They are blind and don't know any better, they are doing what they best know to do, and many are even seeking guidance but unfortunately those who have it will NOT share it

   b. **We are actively HIDING the light of the gospel from those that are lost and blinded when we are not sharing it**

      i. If we are saved then we have already obeyed the gospel and now we carry that light everywhere we go. If we are not sharing it then we are actively hiding it.

   c. **We emphasize not sinning when we are no longer even under the law. We ought to care about what God cares about and talks about and commands over and over again in the NT: SHARING THE GOSPEL**

      i. 1 Corinthians 9:16- For though I preach the gospel, I have nothing to glory of: for necessity is laid upon me; yea, woe is unto me, if I preach not the gospel!

      ii. Think about the Great White Throne Judgment. What excuses will be good enough on that day? In the video we thought that the excuses of the one friend were so ridiculous it was comical; BUT on that day, it will be much worse, and the stakes will be much higher

4. **TOOK**- **Share the gospel with 1 more person this week than you did last week**

   a. Luke 15:10- Likewise, I say unto you, there is joy in the presence of the angels of God over one sinner that repenteth.



The Key of David: The Key to Everything

1) The Key of David- Love for the Word of God

a) Psalm 112:1; 119: 47, 48, 97, 113, 119, 127, 140, 159, 165, 167

i) We love, study, think about, and obey the word of God, because that is how we love, study, think about, and obey the God of the Word.

2) Psalm 1:1-3

a) ***The Key to staying away from sin, bad counsel, and scornfulness*** (vs. 1-2)

i) Psalm 119:9-11; 101

(1) What does it mean to "delight" and "meditate" on God's word?

(a) Delight- A high degree of pleasure, or satisfaction of mind; joy.

(2) What does it mean to "meditate" on God's word?

(a) Meditate- "To dwell on any thing in thought; to contemplate; to _____;"

(3) What does it mean to "keep" God's word?

(a) Keep- To hold; to retain in one's power or possession; not to lose or part with. To have in custody for security or preservation.

(i) It is much more than just "having" something in the Bible; it is an intimate word meaning to care for, watch over, hold close, LOVE!

b) ***The Key to*** _____(vs. 2)

i) Isa. 26:3; Psa. 119:165; Prov. 3:1-2

(1) When your mind is truly stayed on God, meditating on his word, seeking to share his word, investing his word in others: your whole life is about his word: you will be in perfect peace.

c) ***The Key to*** _____***in ministry*** (vs. 3)

i) John 15:1-8; Rev. 3:7-8

(1) Jesus makes it clear that without him (the word) we can do NOTHING! The word of God is key to fruitfulness (you will bear fruit in your season, you may not always know when that will be)

d) ***The Key to*** _____***in everything you do*** (vs. 3)

i) Joshua 1:7-8; Deut. 29:9; 30:9-10; 1 Kings 2:3; 1 Chron. 22:12-13; 2 Chron. 31:20-21

(1) These verses all connect in showing us that EVERYTHING ELSE, not included in the above list, also with prosper when we love, keep, and meditate on the word of God. When our lives are built on and around the word of God:

e) Do you possess this key today?

i) What consumes your mind, your thoughts, your time?

ii) Who are you thinking about the most? You? Or are you seeking God and what he wants, his desires?

iii) If you life is full of sin, lacks peace, lacks fruit, and is not prospering in all things; ask yourself, why? How is your relationship to the word of God today?



The Key of David: The Key to Everything

The heavy steel door slammed shut, and the digital timer on the wall immediately began counting down from 60:00.

Miles didn’t waste a second. He was a whirlwind of energy. He tore the room apart—ripping books off shelves, flipping over mattress cushions, forcefully yanking on locked cabinets, and punching random sequences into the keypad by the door. Sweat dripped down his face. He was working harder than anyone I’ve ever seen. He was frantic, exhausting himself, convinced that if he just tried enough combinations, one of them would eventually work.

Jonah stood still. He didn't move a muscle for the first two minutes. He just scanned the room until his eyes locked on a small, unassuming framed manifest hanging near the floor. He walked over, slid the backing off the frame, and a small, silver skeleton key fell into his palm.

Miles was panting, his knuckles white as he tried to pry a drawer open with his bare hands. He looked back at Jonah and snapped, "Are you going to help, or just stand there?"

Jonah didn’t answer. He walked past Miles, stepped up to the massive, locked chest in the center of the room—the one Miles had been kicking in frustration—and inserted the silver key.

The chest clicked and popped right open. Inside wasn't the exit, but the guide. It was a map. It revealed every hidden compartment, every code, and the exact sequence needed to escape.

Miles froze. He looked at the chaos he had created—the overturned furniture, the mess, the wasted energy. Then he looked at the map in Jonah’s hands.

You see Miles had all of the desire in the world to win this escape room, but what he didn’t have was the key. He rushed to get to work instead of getting that all important key first. He wanted to get out more than anything. But Jonah had the key. And in that room, effort without the key wasn't just difficult—it was useless.

This is how too many of us live our Christian lives. We run around frantically: serving, ministering, teaching, giving, and doing all “good things” we should be doing; but all too often we do it running around without the key, ultimately not accomplishing anything for the Lord.

This key is what we want to find in the word of God today. The Bible calls this the “key of David”

> **Isaiah 22:22-** “And the key of the house of David will I lay upon his shoulder; so he shall open, and none shall shut; and he shall shut, and none shall open.”
>
> **Rev. 3:7-** “These things saith he that is holy, he that is true, he that hath the key of David, he that openeth, and no man shutteth; and shutteth, and no man openeth.”

When you study out these two passages you find that the key of David opens doors that can only be opened with this key and it leads to houses of treasure that only God can give access to. It is given this title because this key was the “key” quality of David/his life” that made him a man after God’s own heart. This is the key we will be looking for today in the word of God.

So today, we want to look at this key to the life of David and see how this passage in psalms lays out for us how it really is the key to everything in our lives: our ministries, peace of mind, families, fruitfulness, joy, service, etc..

1) The Key of David- Love for the Word of God
   a) Psalm 112:1; 119: 47, 48, 97, 113, 119, 127, 140, 159, 165, 167
      i) We love, study, think about, and obey the word of God, because that is how we love, study, think about, and obey the God of the Word.
   b) The passage we are going to be focusing in on today is Psalm 1. This chapter gives us a great view of this "key" in the Bible. God begins the Psalms (which were written primarily by David) with the key to the life of David.
      i) David was not a great guy by any means, it was not for his outstanding character and perfect living that he was called "a man after God's own heart"
         (1) a. Adultery with Bathsheba
         (2) b. Murder of Uriah
         (3) c. Multiple Wives
         (4) d. Concubines
         (5) e. Numbering the people resulting in death of 70,000 people of Israel
         (6) f. Bad handling of his family matters resulting in rebellion of his children
         (7) g. His personal sin and its consequences on the sins of his children
            (a) It was his love for God and his word that made him who he was! A man who loves the word of God may fall and sin, BUT HE WILL REPENT! You may not be the best at something, the most skilled, you may be a screw up (I know I am, my family can vouch for that), but THE KEY YOU NEED IS THIS LOVE FOR THE WORD OF GOD, IT COVERS A MUTLTITUDE OF SINS!
            (b) HOLD YOUR PLACE IN PSALM 119 AND GO TO PSALM 1
2) Psalm 1:1-3
   a) ***The Key to staying away from sin, bad counsel, and scornfulness*** (vs. 1-2)
      i) Psalm 119:9-11; 101
         (1) Verse 4 indicates the same idea! ("the ungodly are not so")
         (2) We cannot just try and live lives as "good little Christian boys and girls" and make our whole lives about "who sins the least". That is not what life is about!! That is a religious made up idea. (not saying we ought to sin)
         (3) However, a bi product of loving and meditating on the word of God is that we will be more like Christ and we won't be involved in these things anymore (Jn. 17:17- "Sanctify them through thy truth, thy word is truth")
         (4) What does it mean to "delight" and "meditate" on God's word?

(a) Delight- A high degree of pleasure, or satisfaction of mind; joy.

(i) Believe it or not, you can actually find pleasure in God's word and in reading and obeying it! Our world has conditioned us so much to think that we can't and that it is boring. That is a lie!!!

1. Can you honestly say you "delight" in God's word? Or is it a task, dragging yourself to read it and barely spending time in it, being distracted reading it? How much time do you spend in it vs. other things?
2. The opposite of this is those who Paul says in the end times are "lovers of pleasures more than lovers of God". This is all to often an accurate depiction of us.

(5) What does it mean to "meditate" on God's word?

(a) Meditate- "To dwell on any thing in thought; to contemplate; to **study**;"

(i) What is on your mind constantly? How much money is in the bank? The next big game being played? The ending to your favorite show? Work needing to be done? The things you want to buy?

(ii) What occupies your thinking the most? Is it the word of God? Chewing on the thing you are studying and praying to God to help reveal to you? Meditating on how that applies in your life right now? Thinking about how you can share that truth with those around you each day at work/school? Too often, this is not true of us. David said in Psalm 119:36 "Incline my heart unto thy testimonies, and not to covetousness.". Too often, we are meditating on covetousness (idolatry) not on God/his Word

(6) What does it mean to "keep" God's word?

(a) Keep- To hold; to retain in one's power or possession; not to lose or part with. To have in custody for security or preservation.

(i) It is much more than just "having" something in the Bible; it is an intimate word meaning to care for, watch over, hold close, LOVE!!!

b) ***The Key to peace*** (vs. 2)

i) Isa. 26:3; Psa. 119:165; Prov. 3:1-2

(1) So many people struggle with peace today. Anxiety, depression, purposelessness, etc.. all run rampant today more than ever. It is not ALWAYS THE CAUSE, but has a high causal link to "covetousness" (idolatry) for worldly things and NOT for the word of God.

(2) The word of God is eternal and brings joy that is fulfilling and lasting. Nothing else in this world can do that. It is all empty (vanity)

(3) When your mind is truly stayed on God, meditating on his word, seeking to share his word, investing his word in others: your whole life is about his word: you will be in perfect peace.

c) ***The Key to fruitfulness in ministry***(vs. 3)

i) John 15:1-8; Rev. 3:7-8

(1) Jesus makes it clear that without him (the word) we can do NOTHING! The word of God is key to fruitfulness (you will bear fruit in your season, you may not always know when that will be)

(2) The church of Philadelphia possessed the key of David, they "kept" (held close, loved, cherished) the word of God and they FLOURISHED. The church of Laodicea keep the word of God outside (Jesus knocking at the church door). **We have the door locked, the key of David is gone, and jesus is on the outside of the church locked out of his own church!**

(3) People died for the scriptures, took it to the ends of the earth, sold their lives for it and GOD MOVED!! When the word of God has preeminence in our lives/ministries, in the right season, there will be fruit from it!

d) ***The Key to prospering in everything you do*** (vs. 3)

i) Joshua 1:7-8; Deut. 29:9; 30:9-10; 1 Kings 2:3; 1 Chron. 22:12-13; 2 Chron. 31:20-21

(1) These verses all connect in showing us that EVERYTHING ELSE, not included in the above list, also with prosper when we love, keep, and meditate on the word of God. When our lives are built on and around the word of God:

(a) Families will prosper

(b) Jobs will prosper

(c) Ministries will prosper

(d) Churches will prosper

(e) Marriages will prosper

(f) Children will prosper

(g) Finances will prosper

(h) Mental Health/Physical Health will prosper

(i) Etc…

(2) When we hear prosper we think "prosperity gospel" BUT THAT IS NOT WHAT THIS IS! THAT IS A LIE/CHEAPENING THE WORD OF GOD FOR COVETEOUSNESS SAKE!

(a) True prosperity isn't getting rich BUT being content with what God has given you (1 Timothy 6:6-10- But godliness with contentment is great gain. And having food and raiment let us be therewith content.)

(b) True prosperity isn't God healing you miraculously BUT God giving you grace to sustain you and see the bigger picture (blind man and Lazarus; not for sin, but for the glory of God to be displayed)

(c) True prosperity isn't as easy life with no trials BUT realizing that all that will live godly in Christ Jesus shall suffer persecution and that there is a reward for this persecution and a purpose for it!

(d) Etc.. the bottom line is, prosperity is a BIBLE WORD that we ought not be ashamed of because some idol worshipping (covetous) group has taken it and twisted it to mean something it isn't.

(i) When you have this kind of love for the word of God, your life and viewpoint is that it is NOT ALL ABOUT YOU, BUT ABOUT HIM! And so whatever he does/chooses to use you for, you PROSPER,

because you see he is working, he is in it!!! Even if it isn't "convenient" for you. Because you are not concerned about you, your desires, but him, his glory, and his word!!

e) Do you possess this key today?
   i) What consumes your mind, your thoughts, your time?
   ii) Who are you thinking about the most? You? Or are you seeking God and what he wants, his desires?
   iii) If you life is full of sin, lacks peace, lacks fruit, and is not prospering in all things; ask yourself why? How is your relationship to the word of God today?
   iv) David was a VERY FLAWED MAN. Yet, he was able to be called a man after God's own heart, he was considered the greatest king in Israel; all because of ONE KEY THING: his relationship to and love for the word of God (the God of the word).
   v) If you don't, it doesn't matter how hard you try to live a "good" life, how hard you work, how skilled you are, etc.. you don't have the KEY needed to open the doors only God can open.

Lessons for Laodiceans- Rev. 3:14-21

1) Revelation 3:14-22

- This letter was to an actual historical church that existed in around 90AD in Asia minor BUT
- This passage I believe represents the modern church (about 1900-today). There are many reasons for this, but namely, in chapters 1-3 "church" is mentioned 19x, but from chapter 4-20, "church" is not mentioned even once.
- It seems the letters to these churches in Revelation 2-3 represent periods of church history up to the rapture (chap. 4) and on into the tribulation and eternity future (chap. 6-22)
- Vs. 14- "the Amen (the "truth") In Isa. 65:16 God calls himself the God "of truth" 2x (in Hebrew, literally "Amen"). We live in days of "relative truth" unparalleled any other time in history.
- Vs. 14- "the faithful and true witness"- We live in the information age, yet with more confusion, lies, deceit, and a lack of trust (faith) in anything we hear because of misinformation, Jesus says HE IS THE FAITHFUL AND TRUE WITNESS
- Vs. 14- the "beginning of the creation of God"- Jesus Christ is the creator of the universe. Something that was largely believed in one way or another for most of history until the "theory of evolution" (Charles Darwin and his book "On the Origin of Species" in 1859 & Georges Lemaître (George La-Matre) with the big bang theory in 1927)
- Industrial Revolution (create much more wealth), Civil Rights Movement (BOTH did a lot of good and also created potential pitfalls in many ways)
- For all of these reasons, I believe 100% that if Jesus could be here this morning to share any message with the church, this is what he would have to say; this is what he says of the church today, the modern church as a whole, these are our struggles (even when we do well, because of the nature of the world we live in, these will still be our struggles).

a) Laodicea is a **self-centered** church (vs. 14)

i) The name Laodicea translates literally to "the people's rights/justice to the people; civil rights"

ii) The church "of the Laodiceans" (Rev. 2:1, 8, 12, 18; 3:1, 7, 14)

iii) The church where everything is about "me, my rights, my way, doing right by me"

(1) When your Christian life becomes all about you, even when you are in the right, you are slipping into the Laodicean way- 2 Tim. 3:1-2; Luke 9:23; Phillip. 2:3-4; Rom. 12:10; Eph. 5:21

(a) The first response of Laodicean many times is "justice", getting what we are due, not allowing ourselves to be wronged, we must vindicated, and justice must be served

(b) We love to see justice when we aren't the ones on the receiving end, we tend to like justice to be done to others, especially when we have been wronged.

(c) Laodiceans struggle with this idea. Jesus is showing us that as a whole, the church in this day is marked by self centeredness and selfishness. The church cannot grow/be fruitful this way!

(d) It is contrasted with the church before it, Philadelphia (brotherly love). That church was loving/giving and therefore successful, Laodicea is selfish/interested in taking, and not successful

(2) You may have the "right" to something but is it what is best?- Gal. 5:13; 1 Cor. 10:23-24; Rom. 15:1-2

(a) The Laodicean mindset is to do whatever makes me feel best, whatever I want, what I am entitled to, etc.. be careful of this trap! Just because you have the "right" to something does not make it the best option!

(b) Are you making decisions based on what you can "get away with technically". It is a sign of immaturity in your walk (like Corinth and what paul said to them).

(c) Are you more interested in satisfying your fleshly desire to be vindicated, or more interested in the betterment of others?

(d) This can be seen a lot in the political arena. No doubt our rights allow us to do many things, they allow us freedoms which help our mission BUT if you life becomes about preserving those rights, or arguing for your rights, and NOT about the main things: the gospel and making disciples; then we are out of order. We serve God: rights or no rights. Like Jesus, the disciples, and the early Christians! Rights are not our main focus: they are the focus of Laodiceans.

(e) Your life is not meant to be lived for yourself only OR even primarily, but for God and for others!

(i) Love the Lord your God with all your heart, soul, mind, strength

(ii) Love your neighbor as yourself

1. You are not the top of the list: God and others are

a. Who are you thinking most about in your daily decisions? Daily life? God? Others? Or is it always all about you…

b. Humility- Not thinking less of yourself; but thinking of yourself less

b) Laodiceans' **works** show that they are lukewarm (vss. 15-16)

(1) The modern church as a whole is lukewarm in their works, they ride the fence, they refuse to choose a side; in their **works**; notice their "words" don't match their "works" (thou sayest; I know thy works)

(2) God says he would prefer them to choose; hot or cold. Our lukewarm works make him sick- 1 Kings 18:21; Josh. 24:14-15; Eze. 20:39; Jer. 3:10-11

(a) Our mindset is that if we don't fully commit and do all we should, our nature is to at least "act the part", serve, keep the image, etc.. God says, if you want to be half in and half out, if you want to serve false gods (idols) and me, DON'T; he would rather you just leave him and serve them OR BETTER YET, leave them and serve him; but CHOOSE

(b) God says this church, this behavior makes him SICK (want to throw up). Consider, even Israel made Jesus weep and lament (Matt. 23:37-O Jerusalem, Jerusalem, thou that killest the prophets, and stonest them which are sent unto thee, how often would I have gathered thy children together, even as a hen gathereth her chickens under her wings, and ye would not!) BUT THIS CHURCH doesn't make him weep, it makes him sick!

(c) What do your **works** say about your relationship with God? Not your **words**. Are you cold? Hot? Or, the only place you cannot be; lukewarm.

c) Laodiceans serve the god of **materialism** (vs. 17)

i) Covetousness=Idolatry (Eph. 5:5; Col. 3:5)

ii) This idolatry is the root issue of Laodicea

(1) Judah didn't serve "gods" because they felt like making God mad! False gods promised prosperity and help (Baal was the god of rain, agriculture, and fertility). He represented help in times of drought and mans attempt to make his own way.

(2) It is easy for us to judge when we see them leave God to worship false gods, BUT WE DO THE SAME THING! God has provided for us, and yet we leave him to seek prosperity, wealth, help, from other sources!

(3) They sought what we seek today, maybe our greatest enemy today as the church, the thing that steals us away from God: MATERIALISM

(4) According to a recent study done by Forbes: The average American today is approximately 90 times wealthier than the average person throughout most of human history.

(5) Materialism is not about what you have so much as your "heart desire" towards it

(a) Philadelphia- had the key of David- All good said of them

(b) Laodicea- has material wealth- all bad things said of them

(c) A successful ministry/church/person (Philadelphia)- Loving (coveting) above all else the word of God- Key of David- Psalm 119:36; Psalm 1

(d) A failed ministry/church/person (Laodicea)- Loving (coveting) money/materialism- the Root of all evil- 1 Tim. 6:10

(i) How do you know if you love something? What do you spend the most time thinking about, what do you choose to spend your free time/thoughts on? How would you feel if you lost it?

1. God says we should be content with food and raiment!-1 Tim. 6:6-8

(ii) This is why God says you can't serve him and mammon- Luke 16:13

1. It is NOT POSSIBLE to truly serve God and material possession, money, fortune, prosperity on your own, etc.. (trying to do so will result in "lukewarm middle ground" Laodiceanism that God despises!

d) Laodiceans lack **three** major things (vs. 18)

i) Gold- Eternal reward in Heaven (1 Cor. 3:12-14)

(1) They have the earthly wealth but lack eternal wealth

(2) They will have NOTHING TO show for their lives on judgement day, no eternal reward.

(3) Also related to persecution and trials (1 Pet. 1:7) Laodiceans are so worried about preserving rights, when we in reality need to be worried more about enduring PERSECUTION. Persecution and church growth go hand in hand throughout the Bible and history; whereas easy times and "ease" and church decay go hand in hand as well

ii) White Raiment- Righteousness (Rev. 19:8)

(1) They will be ashamed on judgement day: God uses the language of nakedness to explain the shame they will feel (no white garments) for the unrighteous lives they lead. Laodiceans mix with the world.

iii) Eye Salve- the word of God that helps us see clearly (Psa. 19:8)

(i) Are you seeing clearly or are you walking around blind? If you are not making decisions DAILY through the lens of the word of God, you are walking around blind!

e) The cure for the Laodicean lukewarm condition: **Zealous Repentance** (vss. 19-22)

i) Zeal- "One who engages warmly in any cause, and pursues his object with earnestness."

(1) Zealots- The **Zealots** were a Jewish political and religious movement in the 1st century AD that strongly opposed Roman rule over Judea. They were known for their **militant nationalism, radical resistance to foreign domination, and willingness to use violence** in their pursuit of Jewish independence.

(a) In a word- Terrorists (against Rome)

(b) Simon Zelotes- He was part of this group before his conversion

(2) Those who live this way will be seen as "radical", peculiar, and different than the rest; especially in the midst of a lukewarm time!- Titus 2:14

(a) This world is FULL of "palatable Christianity", people who talk about Jesus, talk about the Bible, but don't obey it zealously like the prophets, disciples, and Jesus himself did!

(b) We don't need anymore middle of the road Christians. JESUS SAID WE NEED MORE ZEALOUS CHRISTIANS TO REPENT AND JUST GO FOR IT.

(3) Our Examples:

(a) The disciples and Jesus- John 15:19; 17:14; Acts 17:6

(b) The prophets of the Old Testament

(i) Jeremiah-

1. Told to not marry or have kids because of the suffering the people would go through- Jeremiah 16:1-2

(ii) Isaiah-

1. Preached naked and barefoot for 3 years- Isaiah 20:2-4

(iii) Ezekiel-

1. Laid on his left side for 390 days, then on his right side for 40 days (symbolizing the sins and consequences of the sins of Israel and then of Judah)- Eze. 4:4-6
2. Cooked his food over dung to show the food Israel would eat in exile- Eze. 4:12-15
3. Shaved his head and beard and then burnt a third of the hair, hit a third of it with the sword, and scattered the rest of it, to show the fate of Jerusalem- Eze. 5:1-4
4. His wife died and he was told to not mourn to show how God's people would lose everything and not be able to mourn- Eze. 24:15-18

(iv) Hosea-

a. Told to marry a prostitute to show the humiliation of being married to an unfaithful person and to show how Judah and Israel have made God feel- Hos. 1:2-3

2) If Jesus could be here this morning, these are the words he would remind us of, this is the warning he gives to our modern church age.

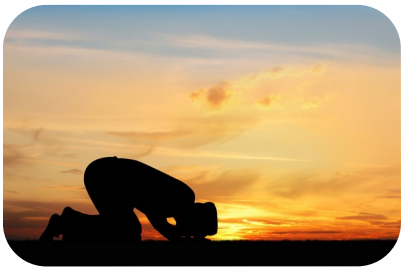
a) Are you living for yourself or others?

b) Are you investing in this world (materialism) or eternity (gospel/discipleship, righteousness, the word of God)?

c) Are you trying to serve God and be “palatable” at the same time? If so, you are in the only place God can’t use you, right in the middle, lukewarm. Be zealous and repent! Choose you this day whom you will serve!

Lessons for Laodiceans- Revelation 3:14-22

1) Revelation 3:14-22
   a) Laodicea is a _____ _____ church (vs. 14)
      i) The name Laodicea translates literally to “the people’s rights/justice to the people; civil rights”
      ii) The church “of the Laodiceans” (Rev. 2:1, 8, 12, 18; 3:1, 7, 14)
      iii) The church where everything is about “me, my rights, my way, doing right by me”
         (1) When your Christian life becomes all about you, even when you are in the right, you are slipping into the Laodicean way- 2 Tim. 3:1-2; Luke 9:23; Phillip. 2:3-4; Rom. 12:10; Eph. 5:21
         (2) You may have the “right” to something but is it what is best?- Gal. 5:13; 1 Cor. 10:23-24; Rom. 15:1-2
   b) Laodiceans’ _____ show that they are lukewarm (vss. 15-16)
      (1) God says he would prefer them to choose; hot or cold. Our lukewarm works make him sick- 1 Kings 18:21; Josh. 24:14-15; Eze. 20:39; Jer. 3:10-11
   c) Laodiceans serve the god of _____ (vs. 17)
      i) Covetousness=Idolatry (Eph. 5:5; Col. 3:5)
      ii) This idolatry is the root issue of Laodicea
         (a) A successful ministry/church/person (Philadelphia)- Loving (coveting) above all else the word of God- Key of David- Psalm 119:36; Psalm 1
         (b) A failed ministry/church/person (Laodicea)- Loving (coveting) money/materialism- the Root of all evil- 1 Tim. 6:10; 1 Tim. 6:6-8
            (i) This is why God says you cant serve him and mammon- Luke 16:13
   d) Laodiceans lack _____ major things (vs. 18)
      i) Gold- Eternal reward in Heaven (1 Cor. 3:12-14)
      ii) White Raiment- Righteousness (Rev. 19:8)
      iii) Eye Salve- the word of God that helps us see clearly (Psa. 19:8)
   e) The cure for the Laodicean lukewarm condition: _____ _____ (vss. 19-22)
      i) Zeal- “One who engages <u>warmly</u> in any cause, and pursues his object with earnestness.”
         (1) Zealots- The **Zealots** were a Jewish political and religious movement in the 1st century AD that strongly opposed Roman rule over Judea. They were known for their **militant nationalism, radical resistance to foreign domination, and willingness to use violence** in their pursuit of Jewish independence.
            (a) In a word- Terrorists (against Rome)
            (b) Simon Zelotes- He was part of this group before his conversion
         (2) Those who live this way will be seen as “radical”, peculiar, and different than the rest; especially in the midst of a lukewarm time!- Titus 2:14
         (3) Our Examples:
            (a) The disciples and Jesus- John 15:19; 17:14; Acts 17:6
            (b) The prophets of the Old Testament



BIBLICAL PRAYER

I. _____ for Prayer (Matt. 6:9-13; Acts 2-4)

a. Jesus gave us an example of prayer to follow; NOT to repeat mindlessly- Matt. 6:9-13

i. Show God reverence- vs 9

ii. Seek His Kingdom and His will today, not ours- vs 10

iii. Ask for our physical needs BUT also deeper spiritual needs today- vs 11 (Jn. 6:51; Job 23:12; Psa. 119:18; 1 Sam. 3:10; James 1:5)

iv. Pray for forgiveness- vs 12 (1 Jn. 1:9)

v. Pray to be led away from temptation and for God's help to deliver you from sin/evil, SO THAT you are prepared to live for ETERNAL THINGS- vs 13

b. Corporate Prayer- Acts 2-4

i. Over and over again we see the early church praying with "one accord", together for the ministry. This is a biblical pattern for us to follow if we want to have successful ministries (Acts 1:13-14; 2:42; 4:24-31)

II. _____ of Prayer

a. Praying in Jesus Name (Jn. 14:13-14)

b. Casting our Cares to Him (1 Pet. 5:7)

c. We can pray about ALL things to Him (Phil. 4:6; Psa. 55:22)

d. All we have to do is ASK (Mat. 7:7-12)

e. He will direct us (Prov. 3:5-6)

f. Prayer brings comfort (Rom. 8:26; 2 Cor. 1:3-4)

III. _____ of Prayer

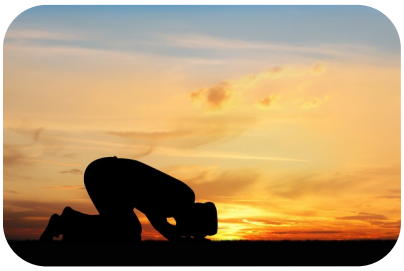
a. Praying effects things- James 5:16-17

b. Prayer effects God- Gen 18:23-33; 2 Kings 20:1-6; Exo. 32:7-14

IV. _____ in Prayer

a. Persistence is necessary- Luke 18:1-8

b. A constant remembering and thoughtfulness about prayer is necessary- 1 Thess. 5:17



BIBLICAL PRAYER

I. **Pattern** for Prayer (Matt. 6:9-13; Acts 2-4)
   a. Jesus gave us an example of prayer to follow; NOT to repeat mindlessly- Matt. 6:9-13
      i. Show God reverence- vs 9
      ii. Seek His Kingdom and His will today, not ours- vs 10
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II. **Promises** of Prayer
   a. Praying in Jesus Name (Jn. 14:13-14)
   b. Casting our Cares to Him (1 Pet. 5:7)
   c. We can pray about ALL things to Him (Phil. 4:6; Psa. 55:22)
   d. All we have to do is ASK (Mat. 7:7-12)
   e. He will direct us (Prov. 3:5-6)
   f. Prayer brings comfort (Rom. 8:26; 2 Cor. 1:3-4)
      i. Greek word "parakaleo" also translated elsewhere 6x as "prayer"

III. **Power** of Prayer
   a. Praying effects things- James 5:16-17
   b. Prayer effects God- Gen 18:23-33; 2 Kings 20:1-6; Exo. 32:7-14
      i. Consider the FIRST AND GREATEST SUPERNATURAL act in your life, your salvation. This was done through PRAYER.
      ii. We can plan, maneuver, coordinate, organize, etc…for good things and be very busy, BUT if our work is not bathed in prayer, God's power in it is AT BEST limited. We are trusting our own abilities to make change.
      iii. Prayer is not FLASHY and out front, it is hidden and quiet and doesn't showcase our "talents". Yet it is necessary in order to see an impact made on eternity!

IV. **Persistence** in Prayer
   a. Persistence is necessary- Luke 18:1-8
   b. A constant remembering and thoughtfulness about prayer is necessary- 1 Thess. 5:17

Proverbs 11

Wisdom for Young People

High school devotional lesson • 20–25 minutes

Teaching pace: Opening 2 minutes; four points 4–5 minutes each; closing 2–3 minutes. Read the passages aloud, explain the key words, and allow a brief response to each question.

Opening

Proverbs 11 places the ways of the upright beside the ways of the wicked. We will consider four choices that affect us now: honesty, humility, speech, and generosity. As we read, ask the Lord to show you where His wisdom needs to change your daily walk.

1 Walk Honestly

A God delights in honest dealings

> **Proverbs 11:1** — "A false balance is abomination to the LORD: but a just weight is his delight."

Words and setting: A balance was a scale used in buying and selling. False weights cheated the other person; a just weight gave the proper amount. Abomination means something God detests. The verse concerns actual business dealings, and it reveals how seriously God regards honesty.

> **Leviticus 19:35–36** — "Ye shall do no unrighteousness in judgment, in meteyard, in weight, or in measure. Just balances, just weights, a just ephah, and a just hin, shall ye have: I am the LORD your God, which brought you out of the land of Egypt."

Meteyard refers to measuring length; an ephah was a dry measure and a hin a liquid measure. God required fair measurements in ordinary trade.

B Let integrity guide your choices

> **Proverbs 11:3** — "The integrity of the upright shall guide them: but the perverseness of transgressors shall destroy them."

Words to understand: Integrity is moral soundness and uprightness. Perverseness is crookedness or the deliberate twisting of what is right. The contrast is between a life directed by what is right and a life ruined by its own dishonesty.

> **Ephesians 4:25** — "Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another."

> **Luke 16:10** — "He that is faithful in that which is least is faithful also in much: and he that is unjust in the least is unjust also in much."

Short devotion: The Lord delights in truthfulness. We can seek His pleasure in an ordinary decision, even when telling the truth costs us something. Ask Him for an honest heart, and correct what you know has been dishonest.

Discuss: According to verse 3, what should guide a decision before we consider what we might gain from it?

2 Receive Counsel Humbly

A A humble heart can receive wisdom

> **Proverbs 11:2** — “When pride cometh, then cometh shame: but with the lowly is wisdom.”

Words to understand: Pride here is an arrogant, self-important attitude. Lowly means humble or modest. A lowly person is willing to acknowledge his need for God and for instruction. Humility makes us teachable.

> **Proverbs 16:18** — “Pride goeth before destruction, and an haughty spirit before a fall.”

Haughty means arrogantly lifted up. Pride makes a person confident in himself while he is moving toward trouble.

> **James 4:6** — “But he giveth more grace. Wherefore he saith, God resisteth the proud, but giveth grace unto the humble.”

James takes humility beyond our relationships with people. Our proud resistance places us against God; a humble heart receives His grace.

B Godly counsel helps protect your steps

> **Proverbs 11:14** — “Where no counsel is, the people fall: but in the multitude of counsellors there is safety.”

Words and setting: Counsel means guidance or wise advice. The people points first to a community that needs sound leadership. The same need for counsel in an individual life is stated directly in Proverbs 12:15.

> **Proverbs 12:15** — “The way of a fool is right in his own eyes: but he that hearkeneth unto counsel is wise.”

Hearkeneth means listens with attention and regard. Being sure of our own opinion does not make it right. Seek counsel from people who know Scripture and will help you obey it. A multitude of opinions cannot overrule what God has said.

Short devotion

We often want advice that agrees with a decision we have already made. A humble heart is willing to be corrected. When Scripture exposes something wrong, we can confess it and receive the help God gives. That willingness to listen is itself a mark of wisdom.

Discuss: How does Proverbs 12:15 help us recognize pride in our response to advice?

Personal response: Ask the Lord to make you willing to hear biblical counsel from your parents, pastor, or another mature believer, especially where you tend to become defensive.

3 Speak Carefully

A Understanding teaches us when to be quiet

> **Proverbs 11:12** — “He that is void of wisdom despiseth his neighbour: but a man of understanding holdeth his peace.”

Words to understand: Void of wisdom means lacking sound understanding. Despiseth means treats as contemptible or looks down on. Holdeth his peace means restrains his speech. The wise person refuses to use words to belittle his neighbour.

> **James 1:19–20** — “Wherefore, my beloved brethren, let every man be swift to hear, slow to speak, slow to wrath: For the wrath of man worketh not the righteousness of God.”

Swift to hear means ready to listen. Slow to speak calls for restraint; slow to wrath means we should not rush into anger. Our anger does not accomplish the righteousness God desires.

B A faithful spirit handles information carefully

> **Proverbs 11:13** — “A talebearer revealeth secrets: but he that is of a faithful spirit concealeth the matter.”

Words to understand: A talebearer carries private information from person to person. A faithful spirit is trustworthy and loyal. Concealeth the matter means keeps it from needless exposure. This describes faithfulness toward a neighbour, not permission to cover up harm or wrongdoing.

> **Proverbs 11:9** — “An hypocrite with his mouth destroyeth his neighbour: but through knowledge shall the just be delivered.”

Notice the damage a mouth can do. What we say about another person matters to God even when that person is absent.

> **Ephesians 4:29** — “Let no corrupt communication proceed out of your mouth, but that which is good to the use of edifying, that it may minister grace unto the hearers.”

Corrupt communication is harmful, rotten speech. Edifying means building up. Paul directs us to words that benefit those who hear.

Short devotion

The Lord cares about the person we are talking about. Before we speak, we should consider whether our words are faithful, necessary, and helpful. The same responsibility applies to a message we type. Ask God to help you restrain hurtful words and speak what will strengthen someone else.

Discuss: What do Proverbs 11:13 and Ephesians 4:29 tell us to consider before repeating something about another person?

4 Give Willingly

A Refuse to hold back what you ought to give

> **Proverbs 11:24** — "There is that scattereth, and yet increaseth; and there is that withholdeth more than is meet, but it tendeth to poverty."

Words to understand: Scattereth here means distributes generously. More than is meet means more than is proper or right: a person holds back what he ought to share. The verse contrasts generosity with grasping selfishness.

> **2 Corinthians 9:7** — "Every man according as he purposeth in his heart, so let him give; not grudgingly, or of necessity: for God loveth a cheerful giver."

Purposeth means decides or intends. God values willing giving from the heart. Grudgingly means reluctantly; of necessity means under compulsion.

B Seek to refresh others

> **Proverbs 11:25** — "The liberal soul shall be made fat: and he that watereth shall be watered also himself."

Words and picture: Liberal means generous. Made fat is an old expression for being enriched or well supplied. Watereth pictures refreshing and sustaining others. These words describe the blessing of generosity; they do not promise a fixed financial return.

> **2 Corinthians 9:8** — "And God is able to make all grace abound toward you; that ye, always having all sufficiency in all things, may abound to every good work:"

> **Acts 20:35** — "I have shewed you all things, how that so labouring ye ought to support the weak, and to remember the words of the Lord Jesus, how he said, It is more blessed to give than to receive."

Scripture connection: Paul connects God's provision with continued good works. In Acts, he connects labour and giving with helping the weak.

Short devotion: Generosity grows as we trust God with what He has given us. We can help someone with what we have now. Ask the Lord to show you a need you can meet willingly, without seeking attention or repayment.

Discuss: What do these passages say about the purpose and the attitude of our giving?

Closing Respond to the Lord

> **Ephesians 2:8–10** — "For by grace are ye saved through faith; and that not of yourselves: it is the gift of God: Not of works, lest any man should boast. For we are his workmanship, created in Christ Jesus unto good works, which God hath before ordained that we should walk in them."

Salvation is God's gift, received through faith in Jesus Christ. The good works of verse 10 follow the salvation of verses 8–9. As believers, we should let His Word shape our conduct. Which area needs your attention today: honesty, humility, speech, or generosity? Name one obedient step before the Lord and ask Him for help to take it.

Closing prayer: Lord, show us where we are resisting Your Word. Give us humble hearts to receive it and willing hearts to obey it. Help our choices and our words honour You. In Jesus' name, amen.



THE TEARS OF [illegible]

I. **Tears of Love: Jesus Wept in** _____ (*John 11:35*)

   a. Why did He cry? He knew he was going to raise Lazarus from the dead, that was nothing for him. He cried because he understood the pain of those, he loved around him and it hurt him! (*John 11:33)*

   b. We read that Jesus was "deeply moved in spirit and troubled" when He saw their sorrow. He felt their pain. He entered their suffering.

   c. God is acquainted with our sufferings! -Hebrews 4:15

   d. We are called to do the same thing! We need to meet others where they are at! - Romans 12:15

II. **Tears of Lament: Jesus Wept Over the Spiritual** _____ **of Others** (*Luke 19:41*)

   a. Here Jesus laments over Israel and what they could have been and the peace they could have had- Matthew 23:37

      i. Jesus lamented their spiritual blindness. He knew they had rejected Him, their Messiah, and because of that, they would face judgment. They could've had peace, but they chose pride and sin instead.

      ii. This story is a warning for us. When we refuse to repent and reject God's truth, we miss out on His peace. We can end up wandering through life, suffering unnecessarily because of our stubbornness- Proverbs 29:1; Galatians 6:7-8; Proverbs 1:24-31

   b. This applies to us personally, but it also applies to those around us. Jesus wept over Jerusalem because He loved them, even though they were far from God. Do we weep over the lost and the wayward?

      i. Look at Paul's heart for those he knew that were lost- Romans 9:1-3; 10:1; 1 Corinthians 9:19-22

   c. We are called to the ministry of reconciliation- 2 Corinthians 5:18-20

III. **Tears of Loyalty: Jesus Wept in** _____ **to God's Will**- Hebrews 5:7-9

   a. Sometimes, God calls us to do hard things

      i. When God calls us to do something, no matter how hard it is, we must be willing to submit. Luke 9:23

      ii. Imagine if he had not obeyed. Where would we be?

      iii. Do you want to be made perfect before God? Troubles, agony, and hard decisions are required! (vs 9)

IV. How can you:

   a. Meet others where they are at and empathize for them?

   b. Lament the spiritual state of those around you and be part of reconciling them to God?

   c. Submit to God in something that is extremely hard to do but can give him the most glory and perfect you in the process?



THE TEARS OF [illegible]

I. **Tears of Love: Jesus Wept in Empathy** (*John 11:35*)
   a. Why did He cry? He knew he was going to raise Lazarus from the dead, that was nothing for him. He cried because he understood the pain of those, he loved around him and it hurt him! (*John 11:33*)
   b. We read that Jesus was "deeply moved in spirit and troubled" when He saw their sorrow. He felt their pain. He entered their suffering.
   c. God is acquainted with our sufferings! -Hebrews 4:15
      i. Think about all of the things Jesus went through on this earth: Pain, Sickness, heartache, hard work (for 30 years he worked before he began his ministry), hunger and thirst, fatigue, anger, temptation, learning new things (he grew in wisdom), subjected himself to a physical body and could not be all places at once (he limited himself), and eventually was even obedient to death!
      ii. What a God we have that understands us!!!
   d. We are called to do the same thing! We need to meet others where they are at! -Romans 12:15
      i. Have you ever considered why we go through trouble in this life? Why would God allow us to go through trouble? He loves us and wants to give us everything! But trouble and pain help us to help others and meet them where they are at. They grow us. They are necessary, even for Jesus!

II. **Tears of Lament: Jesus Wept Over the Spiritual Decay of Others** (*Luke 19:41*)
   a. Here Jesus laments over Israel and what they could have been and the peace they could have had- Matthew 23:37
      i. Jesus lamented their spiritual blindness. He knew they had rejected Him, their Messiah, and because of that, they would face judgment. They could've had peace, but they chose pride and sin instead.
      ii. This story is a warning for us. When we refuse to repent and reject God's truth, we miss out on His peace. We can end up wandering through life, suffering unnecessarily because of our stubbornness- Proverbs 29:1; Galatians 6:7-8; Proverbs 1:24-31

1. This is a WARNING. Get right, receive the word of God (Jesus/Bible) when it comes to you or else you are in danger of a life of death and chaos (look at ISRAEL). You are offered peace and safety with God if you repent!

b. This applies to us personally, but it also applies to those around us. Jesus wept over Jerusalem because He loved them, even though they were far from God. Do we weep over the lost and the wayward?

i. Think about this kind of burden Jesus had for them. Is this your attitude towards those who are lost or who are not walking with the Lord?

ii. When was the last time you checked up on those in this church/youth group who aren't here anymore? The people who have come and go from the group?

iii. Look at Paul's heart for those he knew that were lost- Romans 9:1-3; 10:1; 1 Corinthians 9:19-22

c. We are called to the ministry of reconciliation- 2 Corinthians 5:18-20

i. Paul again reminds us of the simplest ministry we have been given, reconciliation. Reconciling the lost to Christ and the saved to Christ. If someone is not saved, we bring them to salvation in Christ, if someone is saved, we are to be always bringing them closer to Christ. In drama or issues between the body of Christ, we reconcile others and ourselves.

III. **Tears of Loyalty: Jesus Wept in Submission to God's Will**- Hebrews 5:7-9

a. This verse points us to Gethsemane, where Jesus prayed when he was preparing to go to the cross

b. Jesus knew the cross was coming. He knew the physical agony He would endure and the weight of the world's sin He would bear. But despite His fear, He submitted fully to the Father's plan.

c. Sometimes, God calls us to do hard things

i. When God calls us to do something, no matter how hard it is, we must be willing to submit. Luke 9:23

ii. Again, Jesus is our great example of this, he was GOD and yet he chose to submit (obedient unto death) when it was the hardest you could possibly imagine. HE COULD HAVE BEEN DELIVERED AND DECIDED NOT TO DO IT (vs 7)

iii. None of us will be asked to do something like what Jesus did here, this was much harder than anything we could imagine. This is our God, he does the

hardest things, endures the most agony, feels the emotion of fear, all FOR US and so that we know HE UNDERSTANDS.

iv. Imagine if he had not obeyed. Where would we be?

v. Where will others around you be if you refuse to obey? Can your disobedience be the reason they die and go to hell? Can it be the reason others do because you refuse to go and reach out to someone who needs it who is already saved? Who could THEY have reached?

vi. We NEVER KNOW the fullness of Gods plans and we cannot afford to cut and run when it gets tough. Eternities depend on it.

1. Think about this when you go to invite your friends to the outreach, when you go to share the gospel with them, when you don't reach out to that youth group friend you haven't seen in a while.

vii. Do you want to be made perfect before God? Troubles, agony, and hard decisions are required! (vs 9)

IV. How can you:

a. Meet others where they are at and empathize for them?
b. Lament the spiritual state of those around you and be part of reconciling them to God?
c. Submit to God in something that is extremely hard to do but can give him the most glory and perfect you in the process?